

SPPA: A Runtime Contract and Preliminary Prototype for Semantic Primitive Proxy Actors in UAV Digital Twins

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Abstract

Telemetry-driven UAV digital twins can receive object-level perception messages that are too sparse to render as recognizable actors directly. This creates a semantic telemetry-to-actor gap: the perception stream may provide a class, confidence, pose estimate, bounding region, or footprint, while the rendering layer needs an immediately visible object with meaningful occupied volume and predictable cost. This paper specifies and preliminarily instruments Semantic Primitive Proxy Assembly (SPPA), a bounded representation contract for compiling semantic labels into low-polygon proxy actors made of boxes, cylinders, ellipsoids, cones, and tori. SPPA is not a planner occupancy map, not a certified detect-and-avoid layer, not a 3D reconstruction method, and not a replacement for video. It is a proposed actor-representation layer within a larger UAV digital-twin pipeline. The current artifacts include a seven-class OBJ/MTL debug prototype, an open-label Python fallback path, a Python `SPPA-DESC-0.2/SPPA-UPD-0.2` descriptor and update-packet implementation, and a native Unreal/Perforce backend-switch plus descriptor-ingestion smoke test, Editor-Cmd actor microbenchmark, and component payload replay; they do not yet consume live YOLO tracks inside Unreal or provide VR/user validation. We provide the runtime contract, descriptor schema, semantic compiler specification, evidence-status table, preliminary local stress tests against text/image-to-3D generators, lifecycle timing measurements, descriptor/update-packet measurements, a packaged internal Unreal render benchmark, and a preregistered evaluation roadmap. Claims about dense VR frame rate, operator readability, fallback behavior, bandwidth, and end-to-end UAV operation remain pending empirical validation.

1 Motivation

Pipeline B replaces continuous video transmission with lightweight semantic telemetry. The UAV does not transmit every pixel of the camera stream; it transmits object-level meaning: class label, confidence, position, timestamp, and approximate geometry. The ground station reconstructs the operational scene inside a Cesium-enabled Unreal Engine digital twin for a remote pilot wearing VR goggles.

This architecture creates a practical rendering problem. A detector may report many classes: people, cyclists, cars, trucks, animals, vegetation, poles, barriers, construction machinery, unknown obstacles, and rare objects. A digital twin cannot realistically maintain a complete, manually curated 3D asset library for every object that might appear during real-world UAV operation. Even if a large library is available, asset retrieval, licensing, semantic matching, level-of-detail management, and runtime loading remain operational problems.

Modern image-to-3D and text-to-3D models address a different objective. They are designed to create visually rich 3D assets from images or prompts. This is valuable for content creation, simulation authoring, games, and design. However, remote UAV piloting has a different priority: a detected object must appear in the pilot’s synthetic world under a predictable rendering budget. In the current local debug path, SPPA emits coarse proxy meshes in milliseconds; this is a measured prototype property, not a claim that every neural generator necessarily requires seconds under every configuration.

2 Core Idea

The proposed system performs semantic primitive proxy generation. The key claim is simple:

For telemetry-driven UAV visualization, the digital twin may not need to reconstruct the true mesh of every detected object. The hypothesis is that a low-latency, low-polygon, semantically recognizable volume can preserve enough operational context to justify further pilot-facing evaluation.

Instead of producing a detailed mesh, the system assembles predefined geometric primitives into a proxy structure. The proxy is not only selected by class name; it is selected by a lightweight semantic and morphological interpretation of that class. If the detector reports `cow`, the system can infer that the object is an animal, a mammal, and a quadruped. That immediately constrains the proxy to include a body volume, a head volume, four legs, and an orientation hypothesis. If the detector reports `truck`, the system can infer a long vehicle body, a cab, wheels, and an elongated footprint. The silhouette then adjusts the proportions: a long truck and a short truck share the same semantic template, but the cargo body is scaled differently. For example:

- a cow may be represented by ellipsoids for body and head, cylinders for legs, and cones for horns;
- a cyclist may be represented by two torus wheels, a simple bicycle frame, and a human torso/head proxy;
- a tree may be represented by a cylinder trunk and clustered green volumes;
- a car or truck may be represented by boxes and wheel tori;
- a bush may be represented by overlapping green ellipsoids.

The exact geometry is intentionally crude. Its purpose is to preserve, pending empirical validation:

- approximate occupied volume;
- object class recognizability;
- spatial location;
- scale relative to the scene;
- extremely low rendering complexity.

Scale and proportion adaptation are only partially implemented, but the implemented vehicle path is no longer a root-scale deformation of the whole actor. For supported vehicle archetypes, explicit metric dimensions drive a semantic part-layout rule: a longer truck extends the cargo/body span and axle placement while cab and wheel dimensions remain bounded by their own part priors. The Unreal update path likewise rejects shape updates that contain only a new global scale and requires replacement part parameters for `shape_param_update`. Observed-silhouette part fitting remains specified but unevaluated. Non-vehicle archetypes still use template priors or coarse fallback dimensions. This is important for UAV piloting: when flying over an object, the relevant question is not whether the rendered actor is visually beautiful, but whether its occupied volume and part semantics are approximately correct for navigation and operator interpretation. That claim remains a validation target until the planned volume-error and operator studies are completed.

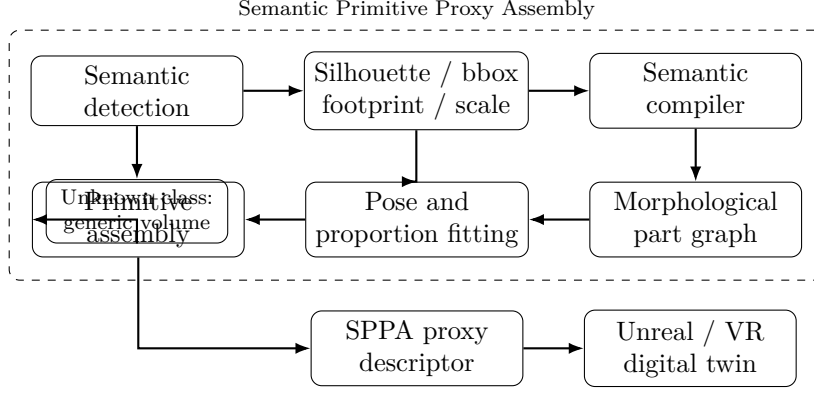


Figure 1: SPPA is specified to convert semantic telemetry into a low-polygon, proportion-adaptive proxy. The semantic compiler maps a detected label to a constrained morphological archetype and part graph, while the silhouette, bounding box, footprint, and temporal track constrain orientation, scale, and part proportions. The output is a runtime-oriented proxy volume intended for later VR evaluation, not a high-fidelity mesh.

3 Operational Scope and Non-Claims

The contribution claimed in this manuscript is intentionally narrow. SPPA is a runtime representation contract for pilot-facing proxy actors, not the flight system itself. Pipeline B provides the broader telemetry, networking, tracking, Unreal/Cesium integration, and VR interface context. SPPA addresses only the question of how an object-level semantic state can be represented visually when a curated asset is unavailable, too costly, or insufficiently matched to the observed object.

The testable claim is therefore:

For telemetry-driven UAV digital twins, track-persistent semantic primitive actors may provide a bounded, uncertainty-aware, pilot-facing obstacle volume when image evidence is missing, degraded, or insufficient for high-fidelity asset generation.

This paper does not claim evaluated UAV/VR teleoperation performance. It also does not claim planning-level risk guarantees, collision avoidance, network-efficiency benefit, or operator benefit. Those are evaluation targets, not results.

SPPA’s novelty is not procedural geometry itself; it is the telemetry-to-runtime-rendering contract with track persistence, uncertainty metadata, and optional fallback beside curated asset spawning.

4 Contributions

This manuscript is framed as a runtime-contract paper with preliminary instrumentation. The contributions are separated by evidence status:

1. **Implemented template and fallback artifacts.** A seven-class fixed-template debug prototype exports SPPA-style proxy meshes through an OBJ/MTL batch path. This artifact demonstrates visual style and local generation timing only; it does not implement live telemetry ingestion. Descriptor-level scale evidence and optional native Unreal descriptor ingestion are implemented, including actor-level pose and shape update smoke tests and a packaged synthetic render benchmark up to 100 objects; dense VR/live runtime behavior remains unevaluated. Fallback behavior is smoke-tested in Python/Unreal but not evaluated operationally.
2. **Implemented Python descriptor/update contract.** The current generator emits SPPA-DESC/SPPA-UPD v0.2 artifacts with an explicit semantic resolver contract, bbox/mask/world-pose evidence, yaw provenance and ambiguity, scale source, material source, primitive parts, cost

fields, and scheduler metadata. A companion SPPA-UPD-0.2 packet separates create/regenerate payloads from per-frame pose or shape updates. Unreal now includes an optional native descriptor-ingestion path that constructs primitive components from descriptor `parts[]` and an update-packet path for pose/no-op/shape updates while preserving the existing asset backend as the default.

3. **Preliminary measurements.** We report local timing and mesh complexity measurements for the current template path, descriptor/update packet timing and size measurements, a track-lifecycle replay over available obstacle logs, a packaged internal Unreal render benchmark, and stress tests against selected fast text/image-to-3D generators under a constrained PyTorch allocator budget. These are preliminary operating-point measurements, not statistical or end-to-end UAV/VR validation.
4. **Specified runtime contract.** We define the SPPA descriptor, semantic-to-archetype compiler, part-graph representation, uncertainty metadata, yaw ambiguity handling, and conservative display fallback requirements.
5. **Positioning and evaluation protocol.** We position SPPA as a track-persistent semantic actor representation, distinct from primitive shape theory, occupancy mapping, curated asset loading, and neural 3D asset generation. We provide falsifiable hypotheses and a preregistered evaluation roadmap for the missing Unreal, geometry, operator, fallback, and bandwidth evidence.

5 Research Question and Hypotheses

The scientific question behind SPPA is not whether primitive geometry can look realistic. It is:

What is the minimum semantic-volumetric representation that preserves enough operational information for a future remote UAV visualization interface?

This question leads to falsifiable hypotheses. None of H1–H5 is claimed as evaluated by the current prototype:

6 A Different Runtime Contract from 3D Generation

Recent 3D generative methods have advanced rapidly. DreamFusion introduced a text-to-3D optimization approach using a pretrained 2D diffusion model and score distillation sampling [25]. Magic3D improved quality and speed with a coarse-to-fine strategy, but still reports mesh creation times on the order of tens of minutes [17]. Point-E reduced generation time substantially, producing point clouds in roughly 1–2 minutes on a single GPU, while explicitly trading quality for speed [20]. Shap-E further generates implicit 3D functions from text or image conditions in a matter of seconds [15]. In this manuscript, Point-E and Shap-E are treated as legacy direct text/tag baselines, not as the strongest 2026 image-conditioned asset generators.

More recent feed-forward image-to-3D methods are faster. TripoSR reports single-image mesh reconstruction in under 0.5 seconds [32]. InstantMesh reports diverse single-image 3D assets within approximately 10 seconds [39]. Stable Fast 3D reports textured mesh reconstruction from a single input image in approximately 0.5 seconds [29, 30]. LGM, CRM, and Unique3D are also relevant fast image-conditioned generators [31, 35, 36]. TRELLIS and Hunyuan3D 2.0 focus on high-quality, versatile, textured 3D asset generation using large-scale latent or diffusion architectures [38, 42].

These methods are impressive, but they are not optimized for the same operating point. In UAV VR teleoperation, several constraints become dominant:

Table 1: Falsifiable SPPA hypotheses and current evidence status.

ID	Hypothesis to test	Required baselines	Primary metrics	Status
H1	SPPA is designed to reduce detection-to-visible-actor latency relative to runtime asset loading or neural generation.	box, capsule, low-poly asset load, image-to-3D	P50/P95 latency, triangles, descriptor bytes	PENDING-EXP
H2	SPPA is hypothesized to increase class-family recognition relative to generic boxes, capsules, or label billboards at comparable rendering cost.	3D box, capsule/ellipsoid, billboard label	recognition accuracy, response time, confusion matrix	PENDING-USER
H3	SPPA is designed to preserve footprint and occupied volume better than fixed-scale templates when object proportions vary.	fixed template, bbox-only scale, curated low-poly asset	BEV IoU, volume error, height error	PENDING-EXP
H4	SPPA is hypothesized to scale to dense VR scenes with more predictable rendering cost than detailed mesh assets.	boxes, capsules, low-poly assets, detailed meshes	FPS, CPU/GPU frame time, draw calls	PENDING-BENCH
H5	SPPA is designed to fall back to conservative display volumes under uncertain class, scale, silhouette, or yaw evidence.	no rendering, box, uncertainty volume	containment rate, false-confidence events, operator interpretation	PENDING-SAFETY

- **Per-object latency:** dynamic detections must appear in the digital twin under a fixed runtime budget; neural asset generation may be unsuitable unless it is precomputed, cached, or wrapped in its own tracking/fusion layer.
- **Scene density:** the scene may contain hundreds of people, animals, vehicles, trees, or temporary obstacles.
- **VR frame rate:** the pilot interface must remain stable and comfortable; geometric complexity must be predictable.
- **Input availability:** a clean cropped image suitable for image-to-3D generation may not be available under poor visibility, motion blur, compression, occlusion, or low-confidence detection.
- **Operational sufficiency:** collision avoidance and situational awareness require approximate volume, not photorealistic surface detail.

The proposed primitive-proxy system therefore does not compete with neural asset generation in fidelity. It occupies a different region of the design space: measured millisecond-scale local proxy construction, low-polygon geometry, and class-conditioned volumetric representation.

7 Relation to 3D Detection, Primitive Representations, and Human Factors

The proposed approach is related to several existing research directions. The claim is not that primitive part-based representation is new in isolation. The claim to be tested is narrower: SPPA

Table 2: Operating point of SPPA compared with nearby representation choices.

Method family	Primary out-put	Optimized for	Limitation for UAV/VR
Bounding box	cuboid	speed	weak semantic readability
Curated asset	mesh actor	visual quality	incomplete library, fixed scale
Image-to-3D	detailed mesh	fidelity	latency and mesh complexity
3D detection	3D box/state	localization	not an intended pilot-facing actor
SPPA	part proxy	operational volume	coarse geometry

is a proposed rendering/backend layer that turns semantic telemetry into bounded, low-polygon proxy actors for a UAV digital twin when exact assets or dense reconstruction are unavailable.

7.1 Monocular 3D Object Detection

Monocular 3D object detection predicts 3D properties such as object depth, dimensions, rotation, and oriented 3D bounding boxes from a single image. Omni3D introduced a large benchmark with 234k images, more than 3 million instances, and 98 categories, together with Cube R-CNN as a unified detector across diverse camera and scene types [3]. Recent work also studies open-vocabulary monocular 3D detection, aiming to lift 2D detections into metric 3D space beyond closed class vocabularies [40].

These methods are highly relevant because they can provide exactly the parameters that semantic primitive proxies need: approximate depth, orientation, and dimensions. However, their output is normally a 3D bounding cuboid or object state, not a semantically readable, part-based VR actor. Our proposal can use monocular 3D detection as an upstream estimator, then convert the detected class and dimensions into a low-polygon operational proxy.

7.2 Animal Pose and Animal 3D Reconstruction

For animals, the state of the art includes keypoint-based pose estimation and model-based reconstruction. AP-10K provides a benchmark for mammal pose estimation across 23 animal families and 54 species [41]. 3D-Fauna reconstructs articulated 3D meshes of quadruped animals from a single image within seconds using a pan-category animal model [16]. More recent work such as SAM 3D Animal uses prompts such as masks and keypoints to reconstruct multiple animals in the wild using SMAL-based priors [13].

These systems demonstrate that richer animal reconstruction is possible. The operational question is whether such reconstruction is necessary for UAV teleoperation. For a pilot, the immediate need is often not fur texture, exact limb articulation, or animatable mesh quality. The immediate need is: a large quadruped occupies this volume, its body is oriented in this direction, and this space should be avoided. A primitive proxy can represent that information with substantially lower geometric and runtime cost.

7.3 Primitive and Superquadric Decomposition

Representing objects as combinations of simple shapes is a long-standing idea in computer vision and robotics. Superquadrics are especially relevant because they compactly represent boxes, cylinders, spheres, ellipsoids, and related forms with few parameters. Earlier shape-representation work used generalized cylinders and volumetric components to describe object structure [18], and recognition-by-components proposed that objects can be recognized from arrangements of simple geon-like parts [2]. Superquadric recovery and parsing further developed compact primitive models

for object abstraction [28, 24]. Learned volumetric primitive abstraction also shows that primitive assemblies can capture consistent part structure across shape collections [33], while recent systems such as SuperDec explicitly use superquadric primitives as a compact representation for 3D scene decomposition [10].

This literature is a direct prior, not a minor analogy. SPPA must therefore be judged as an operational telemetry-to-rendering contract rather than as a new theory of primitive shape representation. The remaining open question is whether a constrained primitive representation is useful in the specific Pipeline B setting, compared with simpler boxes/capsules and with existing asset or mapping representations.

7.4 Procedural Actors, LOD, and Scene Graphs

SPPA is also related to procedural modeling, shape grammars, level-of-detail systems, impostors, semantic scene graphs, and bounding-box visualization. These are closer baselines for SPPA’s runtime contract than generic asset-generation systems. Procedural modeling and CGA shape grammars generate structured geometry from compact rules [19]. ShapeAssembly similarly uses executable programs to assemble cuboid part proxies and represent families of related shapes [14]. Against this literature, SPPA’s proposed difference is not procedural generation itself; it is the use of a bounded procedural descriptor as an online telemetry rendering fallback.

Real-time graphics has long used hierarchical level of detail, impostors, and extreme simplification to control rendering cost [4, 5]. Modern engines and geospatial standards continue this line through virtualized geometry, instancing, and tiled streaming representations [8, 23]. SPPA must therefore be benchmarked against low-poly assets, LOD, impostors, and instanced primitive rendering rather than only against neural 3D asset generators.

Semantic scene graphs are another direct neighbor. 3D scene graphs and dynamic scene graphs connect objects, semantics, geometry, dynamics, and actionability [1, 27]. SceneGraphFusion shows that incremental 3D semantic graph prediction can run online from RGB-D sequences [37]. SPPA can be interpreted as a rendering/backend layer for such semantic state, not as a replacement for scene-graph perception. This framing reduces the novelty claim but makes the system boundary clearer.

7.5 Human Factors, Display Uncertainty, and Mapping Baselines

Because the intended output is for a remote pilot, SPPA cannot rely on visual plausibility alone. Situation awareness and workload should be evaluated with established human-factors instruments such as SAGAT and NASA-TLX [6, 7, 11]. Any claim about operator readability, obstacle-avoidance usefulness, or workload reduction is therefore marked PENDING-USER until controlled operator studies are performed.

SPPA also overlaps with robotic mapping representations. Occupancy grids, OctoMap, TSDFs, and ESDFs provide spatial volumes and obstacle-distance information for planning and navigation [12, 22]. These representations are not intended to be semantic proxy actors by themselves, but they are essential baselines for any claim about operational volume. The publishable evaluation must therefore distinguish pilot-facing semantic readability from collision or planning utility.

The closest practical comparison is therefore not “SPPA versus high-fidelity 3D generation,” but SPPA versus no rendering, 3D boxes, capsules/ellipsoids, billboard labels, curated low-poly assets, procedural actors, occupancy-style volumes, and instanced rendering in the target Unreal/VR environment.

8 Operation Inside Pipeline B

SPPA is intended to run at the ground station or inside the rendering component of the digital twin as a subcomponent of Pipeline B, not as the flight system or telemetry architecture itself. The upstream pipeline detects objects, estimates track state, and provides semantic/geometric evidence.

Table 3: Nearest alternatives that should be evaluated before claiming an operational advantage for SPPA. The current manuscript specifies this comparison but does not yet execute the Unreal/VR baselines.

Alternative	What it provides	Why it is a required baseline
3D box / capsule / ellipsoid	Minimal occupied volume and very low render cost	Tests whether semantic part graphs add recognition or volume value.
Billboard label	Fast semantic display with almost no geometry	Tests whether class text alone is enough for operator interpretation.
Curated low-poly asset	Hand-authored recognizable actor	Tests the cost and coverage tradeoff against asset libraries.
Unreal ISM/HISM primitive batches	Native instancing of repeated geometry	Tests draw-call and dense-scene scaling in the target engine.
HLOD / impostor / Nanite asset	Engine-level LOD or virtualized geometry	Tests whether standard graphics tooling already solves the runtime-cost problem.
OctoMap / TSDF / ESDF / occupancy volume	Planning-oriented obstacle volume	Tests containment, clearance, and false-confidence tradeoffs.
3D/dynamic scene graph	Semantic object-state representation	Tests whether SPPA is best framed as a rendering backend for graph state.
3D Gaussian splat / scene asset	Visual scene representation	Tests fidelity when a richer 3D scene representation is available.
Text/image-to-3D mesh	Generated asset from prompt or crop	Tests whether neural generation can replace bounded proxy actors under missing or degraded evidence.
SPPA	Track-persistent semantic primitive actor descriptor	Target method; currently specified and partially prototyped.

SPPA consumes that state only when an entity must be represented, updated, or reparameterized as a pilot-facing proxy actor.

The runtime loop is:

1. The UAV detects an object and estimates its class, confidence, image region, and geospatial position.
2. The ground station associates the detection with an entity track.
3. SPPA selects or updates a semantic part graph for that entity.
4. The silhouette, footprint, and temporal track adjust orientation, scale, and part proportions.
5. Unreal Engine instantiates or updates primitive components using the resulting proxy descriptor.
6. The pilot sees a stable, low-polygon operational representation of the object in VR.

This loop separates perception from visual fidelity. If a high-quality asset is available and affordable, it may be used. If not, SPPA is intended to provide a proportional, semantically meaningful proxy volume; this remains an evaluation target rather than an operational guarantee.

9 Proposed Runtime Contract

SPPA is specified as a fallback or primary lightweight rendering layer inside Pipeline B. Its inputs are semantic detections and geometric estimates from the perception pipeline. Its intended outputs are low-polygon proxy actor descriptors for the digital twin.

The expected telemetry fields are:

- stable entity identifier;
- detected class label;
- confidence score;

Table 4: Semantic primitive proxy runtime contract.

Stage	Input	Output
Detection	image frame	class, confidence, silhouette/bounding box
Georeferencing	UAV pose + camera model	world position and scale estimate
Proxy selection	object class	primitive template or generic fallback
Primitive scaling	silhouette/footprint/volume	scaled proxy geometry
Actor spawning	proxy mesh + transform	Unreal digital twin actor
Runtime update	tracked entity state	pose, scale, confidence, uncertainty

- geospatial position;
- estimated footprint, height, or bounding volume;
- silhouette or 2D bounding box when available;
- timestamp and sensor source;
- uncertainty estimate.

10 SPPA Specification

SPPA is specified as a deterministic compiler contract. It should not call a large generative model at runtime, and it should not search a large asset library. Its task is to transform the minimum available semantic and geometric evidence into an operational 3D proxy descriptor. The specified pipeline is:

1. **Normalize the semantic label.** The detector output is mapped to a semantic path such as `cow` $\rightarrow$ `animal` $\rightarrow$ `mammal` $\rightarrow$ `quadruped` or `truck` $\rightarrow$ `vehicle` $\rightarrow$ `cargo vehicle`.
2. **Select a morphological archetype.** The semantic path selects a small family of part graphs, such as `quadruped`, `biped`, `long vehicle`, `vegetation blob`, `tree-like`, `pole-like`, or `generic obstacle`.
3. **Extract geometric measurements.** The system estimates major and minor footprint axes, aspect ratio, height, ground contact, and yaw candidates from the bounding box, mask, footprint, previous track, and UAV camera geometry.
4. **Fit pose and proportions.** The algorithm chooses a yaw angle and assigns length, width, and height to semantic parts while respecting class-level priors and observed silhouette proportions.
5. **Assemble primitives.** Each semantic part is instantiated as a low-resolution primitive: box, cylinder, ellipsoid, cone, torus, capsule, or superquadric-like approximation.
6. **Estimate uncertainty and fallback.** If class, orientation, or scale is ambiguous, the output includes uncertainty metadata or falls back to a conservative generic volume.

10.1 Semantic Normalization

SPPA should support many class labels without requiring a manually authored asset for each one. The label is therefore mapped to a compact ontology of morphological archetypes. The ontology does not need to be large; it only needs to capture the body plan relevant for operational volume:

Table 5: Evidence status for implemented and partially implemented SPPA components.

Claim or component	Current evidence	Status
Seven fixed proxy templates	Implemented in the debug OBJ/MTL generator and timed through the batch path.	Implemented
Evidence-calibrated material cues	Implemented in Python material manifests and Unreal component tags; recognition and workload effects are not evaluated.	Implemented, pending empirical validation (PENDING-USER)
SPPA descriptor and update-packet contract	Implemented in Python as SPPA-DESC-0.2 and SPPA-UPD-0.2; optionally consumed by a native Unreal actor API that builds primitive components from descriptor <code>parts[]</code> and accepts pose/no-op/shape update packets. The current contract records resolver source, match type, fallback reason, scale source, material source, yaw ambiguity, and shape-confidence flags.	Implemented with actor-level smoke, actor microbenchmark, component payload replay, and local-loopback HTTP replay trace, plus a packaged internal render benchmark; pending VR/live runtime validation (PENDING-BENCH)
Scale- and footprint-conditioned fitting	Descriptor consumes bbox, mask, track pose, yaw evidence, and explicit metric dimensions when supplied; native descriptor ingestion applies descriptor part scales in Unreal and can infer an internal reference volume from parts when later shape-update dimensions arrive, and packaged synthetic update streams are benchmarked up to 100 objects.	Partially implemented, pending real-track and VR validation (PENDING-BENCH)
Unknown-class conservative display fallback	Implemented in Python and Unreal smoke tests as open-label fallback; operator interpretation remains unevaluated.	Implemented, pending empirical validation (PENDING-SAFETY)
End-to-end UAV-to-VR loop	Component payload replay and local-loopback HTTP poll replay are implemented using the <code>/api/ui/data</code> obstacle payload shape; a packaged internal render replay is implemented on synthetic obstacle batches. No live YOLO tracks, camera calibration, georeferenced footprints, real network server, VR headset, or curated-asset replay are evaluated here.	Partially implemented, pending full runtime validation (PENDING-IMPL, PENDING-BENCH)

Table 6: Evidence status for SPPA claims that remain primarily pending.

Claim or component	Current evidence	Status
Dense VR performance	Packaged desktop Tick frame-time and estimated draw/triangle counts are reported for synthetic 10/50/100-object scenes; no headset, GPU profiler counters, curated assets, or VR runtime is reported.	Preliminary packaged benchmark, pending VR/GPU validation (PENDING-BENCH)
Operator readability and situational awareness	No pilot or user study is reported.	Pending empirical validation (PENDING-USER)
SPPA-specific descriptor bandwidth	Preliminary JSON descriptor and update packet byte sizes are measured; comparison against video, telemetry boxes, and mesh transfer remains missing.	Preliminary measurement, pending comparative validation (PENDING-EXP)

10.2 Bounded Semantic-to-Part Compiler

The important architectural step in SPPA is the conversion from a detected semantic label to a constrained geometric part graph. This can be viewed as a semantic compiler. The input vocabulary may be open-ended, but the output is restricted to a finite set of morphological archetypes, semantic roles, and primitive geometries.

Let c be the detected label. A language model, knowledge graph, or manually curated ontology maps c to a semantic descriptor:

$$z_c = \mathcal{L}(c) = (h_c, a_c, q_c, d_c),$$

where h_c is a category hierarchy, a_c is a set of expected attributes, q_c is a set of qualitative morphology cues, and d_c contains coarse dimension priors. For example, a descriptor for **cow** may include **animal**, **mammal**, **quadruped**, **has head**, **has torso**, and **four legs**; a descriptor for **truck** may include **vehicle**, **wheeled**, **cab**, **cargo body**, and **elongated footprint**.

The semantic descriptor selects the closest morphological archetype:

$$A^*(c) = \arg \max_{A \in \mathcal{A}} \text{sim}(\phi(A), z_c) \quad \text{s.t.} \quad \text{risk}(A, z_c) \leq \rho_{\max},$$

where $\mathcal{A}$ is a compact library of archetypes, $\phi(A)$ is the semantic signature of an archetype, and the risk constraint is a PENDING-SPEC validation rule that should prevent over-specific mappings when semantic evidence is weak. The functions sim , risk , descriptor calibration, and threshold $\rho_{\max}$ are not fixed by the current prototype; they must be specified before claiming open-vocabulary coverage. If no archetype is sufficiently reliable, the compiler selects a conservative display obstacle.

The selected archetype is expanded into a semantic part graph:

$$G_c = \Gamma(A^*, z_c) = (V_c, E_c),$$

with nodes

$$v_i = (r_i, \omega_i, \pi_i, \alpha_i, \kappa_i).$$

Here r_i is the semantic role of the part, ω_i is the primitive type selected from a finite primitive alphabet $\Omega = \{\text{box, cylinder, ellipsoid, cone, torus, capsule}\}$, π_i is the anchor relative to the parent part, α_i stores allowed aspect-ratio ranges, and κ_i stores importance and uncertainty metadata. Edges E_c encode attachment and relative placement constraints, such as head-attached-to-torso, wheels-attached-to-chassis, or canopy-above-trunk.

Table 7: Post-cycle evidence delta. This table records what changed after the reviewer-driven implementation cycle and what remains outside the current evidence.

Area	Before this cycle	Current artifact	Still pending
Evidence-calibrated materials	Only a proposed idea; no descriptor or runtime tags	Python JSON/MTL manifests, Unreal component tags, and material ablation	Perceptual recognition, workload, and false-confidence validation
Descriptor/update contract	Runtime descriptor was illustrative text only	Python SPPA-DESC-0.2 descriptors, SPPA-UPD-0.2 packets, scheduler sensitivity, replay rows, native Unreal descriptor ingestion, and packaged synthetic render benchmark	VR/GPU profiler counters and real-track replay
Unknown/out-of-template labels	Specified but unsupported labels could abort the path	Exact labels, keyword archetypes, and generic fallback smoke-tested in Python/Unreal	Operational fallback behavior under real tracks and operator interpretation
Runtime integration	Conceptual relation to Pipeline B	Optional Unreal backend switch remains asset-first by default; semantic proxy path now accepts descriptor JSON, propagates resolver, uncertainty, and source tags, falls back to class templates if absent or invalid, emits update traces through the HTTP replay harness, and has an opt-in packaged internal render benchmark	Detection and live telemetry replay plus VR/GPU frame-time
Generator comparison	Mostly narrative contrast with neural generation	Preliminary local comparison with legacy text and image-conditioned baselines	Broader baseline set, quality controls, and portable-hardware Unreal profiling

Finally, the graph is instantiated as geometry:

$$\mathcal{P}(G_c, \theta) = \bigcup_{v_i \in V_c} T(\pi_i, \theta_i) \omega_i(\alpha_i),$$

where θ_i contains the fitted pose and scale parameters of each part. This equation is the architectural core of SPPA: arbitrary semantic labels are not converted directly into arbitrary meshes; they are compiled into a bounded, low-polygon graph of semantic parts drawn from a finite primitive vocabulary.

This gives SPPA bounded semantic coverage. Any label that can be mapped to a morphological descriptor can be represented by a proxy, even if no exact asset exists. The quality of the proxy depends on the quality of the semantic descriptor and visual evidence, but the specified display policy degrades toward a conservative display volume rather than silently dropping the object.

10.3 Part Graphs

Each archetype is represented by a semantic part graph. Nodes are parts and edges encode relative placement constraints. A node contains:

Table 8: Examples of semantic normalization and archetype selection.

Detected label	Semantic path	Archetype
cow, horse, dog	animal / mammal / quadruped	quadruped
person, pedestrian	human / biped	biped
biker, cyclist	human + two-wheel vehicle	rider vehicle
car, van	vehicle / wheeled	compact vehicle
truck, bus	vehicle / long wheeled	long vehicle
tree	vegetation / trunk + canopy	tree-like
bush, shrub	vegetation / low blob	vegetation blob
pole, mast, tower	vertical structure	pole-like
unknown	obstacle	generic volume

- semantic role, such as torso, head, leg, cab, cargo body, wheel, trunk, canopy, or shaft;
- primitive type, such as box, ellipsoid, cylinder, cone, or torus;
- relative anchor and transform;
- allowed aspect-ratio and scale range;
- recognition importance;
- polygon budget.

For example, a quadruped graph contains a body ellipsoid, a head ellipsoid, a short neck cylinder, four leg cylinders, and an optional tail. A long-vehicle graph contains a cargo box, cab box, wheels, and optional windshield marker. The same graph can represent many real dimensions because part scales are not fixed.

10.4 Measurement Extraction

The system can operate with different levels of geometric evidence:

- **Footprint available:** fit a minimum-area oriented rectangle and extract length, width, aspect ratio, and yaw candidates.
- **Silhouette mask available:** use principal axes, asymmetry, protrusions, and lower contact regions to refine orientation and part allocation.
- **Bounding box only:** combine image-space extent with class priors, UAV pose, and ground-plane assumptions to estimate a conservative volume.
- **Temporal track available:** use velocity and previous yaw to reduce front/back ambiguity and jitter.

This makes the method applicable under degraded sensing. A mask can improve the proxy, but the algorithm is intended to produce a conservative proxy volume for evaluation even when only a class label and a bounding region are available.

10.5 Conservative Fallback

The SPPA specification requires a usable display volume, even when the class is unknown or the silhouette is too weak for reliable part assignment. The fallback is selected from simple geometric evidence:

- elongated and low footprint: oriented capsule or elongated box;
- small footprint and large height: pole-like cylinder;
- low circular footprint: vegetation blob or generic ellipsoid;
- upright human-scale region: biped proxy or vertical capsule;
- ambiguous region: conservative oriented bounding volume.

The fallback is not treated as a successful reconstruction. It is a conservative display mechanism intended to preserve operational continuity when semantic detail is missing. The operator sees a volume with uncertainty, and the digital twin does not silently drop an obstacle. Whether this reduces risk or creates false confidence is a PENDING-SAFETY validation question.

10.6 Pose and Proportion Fitting

SPPA estimates orientation and dimensions by combining weak cues, but the yaw estimate must distinguish axial and directional evidence. Footprint principal axes and silhouette PCA normally provide an unoriented axis modulo π , while velocity, asymmetric part evidence, or a previous signed track yaw can provide a direction modulo 2π . The implementation therefore first estimates an axial orientation

$$\bar{\psi}_t^{\text{axis}} = \frac{1}{2} \text{atan2} \left(\sum_k w_k \sin 2\psi_k^{\text{axis}}, \sum_k w_k \cos 2\psi_k^{\text{axis}} \right),$$

and then assigns the front/back sign only when directional evidence is available:

$$(\psi_t, \text{yaw_ambiguous}) = \text{orient} \left(\bar{\psi}_t^{\text{axis}}, \{\psi_j^{\text{dir}}, w_j\}_j \right).$$

For vehicles, the cabin or velocity may identify the front. For quadrupeds, a head-like protrusion or motion direction may identify the head. If the evidence is weak, `yaw_ambiguous = true` and the proxy remains a symmetric obstacle volume. The exact confidence thresholds for orient are

PENDING-SPEC.

Part dimensions are fitted analytically when possible. For a long vehicle:

$$L_{\text{cargo}} = \alpha L, \quad L_{\text{cab}} = (1 - \alpha)L, \quad \alpha \in [0.55, 0.80],$$

where L is the measured footprint length. Thus a short truck and a long truck are represented by the same graph but different cargo-body scale. For a quadruped:

$$L_{\text{body}} = \beta L, \quad L_{\text{head}} = (1 - \beta)L, \quad H_{\text{leg}} = \lambda H,$$

with β and λ constrained by the quadruped prior and by the observed silhouette. In an implementation, the fitting can be performed by a small discrete hypothesis search over 8–32 candidates rather than a heavy optimization loop.

10.7 SPPA Objective

The full SPPA target is specified as a finite hypothesis selection problem, not as an expensive continuous optimizer. Given a detection D_t , an archetype A , measurements such as footprint F_t , optional mask M_t , and previous track state x_{t-1} , SPPA constructs a small candidate set $\mathcal{H}(A, F_t, M_t, x_{t-1})$. Each candidate separates global pose $\xi_t = (p_t, \psi_t)$ from part parameters q_t , including part scales, local anchors, and fallback mode. The selected proxy is:

$$(\xi_t^*, q_t^*) = \arg \min_{(\xi, q) \in \mathcal{H}(A, F_t, M_t, x_{t-1})} w_F (1 - \text{IoU}_{BEV}(P_{\xi, q}, F_t)) + w_S (1 - \text{IoU}_{mask}(\Pi(P_{\xi, q}), M_t)) \\ + w_T d_{SE(2)}(\xi, \xi_{t-1}) + w_A \ell_A(q)$$

$$\text{s.t.} \quad \text{tri}(P_{\xi,q}) \leq N_{\max}, \quad \hat{\tau}(P_{\xi,q}; E, H) \leq \tau_{\max}.$$

Here $P_{\xi,q}$ is the candidate primitive proxy, IoU_{BEV} measures footprint overlap in bird’s-eye view, IoU_{mask} measures optional image-mask agreement, $d_{SE(2)}$ penalizes pose jitter, and ℓ_A penalizes proportions outside the selected archetype’s allowed ranges. If M_t is unavailable, $w_S = 0$; if no reliable footprint exists, SPPA uses class priors and conservative fallback volumes. The runtime term $\hat{\tau}$ is explicitly hardware- and engine-dependent: E denotes the rendering engine/runtime path and H denotes target hardware. It cannot be proven from triangle count alone and must be measured in Unreal/VR (PENDING-BENCH). The weights w_F, w_S, w_T, w_A , normalization of objective terms, and candidate-generation policy are PENDING-SPEC.

10.8 Role of a Language Model

A language model is not required to generate geometry at frame rate. In SPPA, its role is better understood as a semantic compiler or cache builder. When a new label appears, the language model can propose a descriptor z_c , a parent archetype, and a minimal part graph. That proposal is then reviewed against the finite primitive vocabulary, polygon budget, and conservative display rules of SPPA. Once reviewed and accepted, the mapping can be cached and reused deterministically. The review procedure, prompt/model version, cache contents, and rejection criteria are PENDING-SPEC.

This distinction matters for the target UAV telemetry loop. The runtime loop should not depend on a slow or nondeterministic text-to-geometry call. The language model helps extend the open vocabulary; the runtime path still executes a bounded geometric program. For example, if the detector reports `camel`, the compiler may map it to a quadruped with a larger torso, long neck, and optional hump. If it reports `excavator`, it may map it to a vehicle-like body with tracks, cabin, and arm proxy. If the proposal is uncertain, SPPA falls back to the nearest parent archetype or to a conservative generic volume.

The coverage claim is therefore conditional and operational, not photorealistic. The intended behavior is bounded semantic proxy coverage: exact labels use reviewed templates, recognizable terms may use reviewed keyword archetypes, and unsupported labels receive a generic fallback. This does not guarantee a useful mesh for every object in the world, and it does not yet establish reliable open-vocabulary behavior. The method specifies a constrained proxy-coverage policy, not universal 3D reconstruction.

10.9 Runtime Output

At runtime, the preferred output is not an OBJ mesh. OBJ export is useful for debugging and paper figures, but a deployed Unreal system should receive a compact proxy descriptor that can be rendered using instancing or procedural mesh components:

```
{
  "descriptor_schema": "SPPA-DESC-0.2",
  "semantic": {"raw_label": "truck", "archetype": "truck"},
  "evidence": {"bbox_px": {...}, "mask_hash": "..."},
  "pose": {
    "position_world": {"x": 10.0, "y": 4.0, "z": 0.0},
    "yaw_source": "track_velocity",
    "yaw_modulo": "2pi",
    "yaw_ambiguous": false
  },
  "scale": {"dims_m": {"length": 5.2, "width": 2.3, "height": 2.7}},
  "runtime_policy": {"cache_key": "track-17", "action": "create"}
}
```

The current Python implementation emits this descriptor and a companion SPPA-UPD-0.2 update packet. The Unreal plugin now exposes an optional `ConfigureProxyFromDescriptorJson` path. The existing `UnrealAssets` backend remains the default and ignores SPPA fields; the `SemanticProxy` backend first attempts to consume an embedded descriptor object, or its string-serialized counterpart, from the same `/api/ui/data` obstacle object. It then falls back to the older class/confidence template path if the descriptor is absent or invalid. The smoke test verified a real SPPA-DESC-0.2 fixture with 12 descriptor parts producing 12 Unreal mesh components, material/evidence/uncertainty tags, invalid-JSON rejection without mutating the current proxy, descriptor reconfiguration, and pose-update packet acceptance for an existing descriptor proxy. This is an integration smoke test, not a dense runtime benchmark; in the component path, invalid descriptor/update payloads fall back to the older class/confidence template path.

In the July 2026 descriptor benchmark, full JSON descriptors measured approximately 6.3–8.2 kB at P50–P95 in the synthetic cases, while update packets measured 0.9–4.7 kB at P50–P95. In a 20,392-observation stratified replay subset from seven controller logs expanded over four predeclared shape thresholds, descriptor bytes were 6.2–6.5 kB at P50–P95 and update packets were 1.0–1.4 kB at P50–P95. These are preliminary JSON serialization sizes, not evidence for bandwidth reduction against video, telemetry boxes, or mesh transfer.

10.10 Pseudocode

```
function SPPA(detection, track_state, ontology, archetypes):
    label = normalize_label(detection.class_label)
    semantic_path = ontology.resolve(label)
    measurements = extract_measurements(detection)

    archetype = select_archetype(semantic_path, measurements)
    part_graph = archetypes[archetype]

    pose = fit_pose(
        measurements,
        previous = track_state[detection.track_id],
        semantic_path = semantic_path
    )

    dimensions = fit_dimensions(
        part_graph,
        measurements,
        confidence = detection.confidence
    )

    params0 = analytic_initialization(part_graph, dimensions)
    params = small_hypothesis_search(
        part_graph,
        params0,
        measurements,
        pose,
        max_candidates = 32
    )

    parts = instantiate_primitives(part_graph, pose, dimensions, params)
    parts = enforce_polygon_budget(parts, detection.distance_to_pilot)

    uncertainty = estimate_uncertainty(
```



```

    detection, measurements, pose, dimensions, semantic_path
)

if uncertainty.too_high:
    parts = conservative_fallback_volume(measurements, semantic_path)

proxy = make_proxy_descriptor(label, semantic_path, pose, parts, uncertainty)
track_state.update(detection.track_id, proxy)
return proxy

```

11 Part-Fitting Examples

This section illustrates how the SPPA specification is applied to two common object families. The examples are not special cases; they show how a class prior and observed geometry jointly determine a part graph and its proportions.

The class prior is modeled as a semantic part graph. A class label activates both a category hierarchy and a minimal part structure. For instance:

`cow → animal → mammal → quadruped`

From this hierarchy the system can infer that a proxy should contain at least a body, a head, and four leg supports. Similarly:

`truck → vehicle → {cab, cargo body, wheels}`

This makes the reconstruction compositional. The system is not generating an arbitrary mesh; it is fitting a small semantic graph of geometric parts to the detected silhouette and estimated world scale.

Let a detection be represented as:

$$D_t = (c, p, B, s, \gamma, t)$$

where c is the detected class, p is the estimated world position, B is the image-space bounding box or silhouette, s is an approximate world scale, γ is confidence, and t is timestamp. The proxy generator selects a primitive template:

$$T_c = \{(g_i, r_i, m_i)\}_{i=1}^{n_c}$$

where g_i is a primitive geometry type, r_i is its relative transform within the object, and m_i is its semantic material. More explicitly, each primitive belongs to a semantic part:

$$T_c = \{(a_i, g_i, r_i, \theta_i, m_i)\}_{i=1}^{n_c}$$

where a_i is a part label such as torso, head, leg, cab, cargo body, or wheel, and θ_i contains part-specific scale limits and deformation rules. The final proxy separates global pose, local part transform, and primitive dimensions:

$$P_t = \bigcup_{i=1}^{n_c} T_{\text{world}}(p_t, \psi_t) T_i(a_i, \delta_i) \omega_i(q_i),$$

where T_{world} places the object in the digital twin, T_i places part i relative to its parent, ω_i is the selected primitive, and q_i contains the fitted primitive dimensions.

The silhouette is used to estimate a coarse yaw angle and to allocate scale to the most likely parts. For a quadruped, the largest elongated region is treated as the torso candidate; smaller protrusions near one end suggest head position; thin lower protrusions suggest legs. For a truck,

the elongated body region sets the cargo body length, while a shorter high-volume region can become the cab. In ambiguous cases, the proxy should preserve uncertainty rather than claiming a precise pose.

This proportional fitting is one of the central differences between a fixed asset lookup and a semantic primitive proxy. A conventional asset library may contain a single truck mesh or several manually authored variants. A neural generator may produce a plausible truck mesh, but it is not necessarily conditioned on the real detected footprint in a way that enforces a low-polygon, VR-stable obstacle volume. The primitive proxy instead treats the detected silhouette as a constraint on part proportions. The same template can therefore represent both a short utility truck and a long cargo truck by stretching the cargo body while preserving cab and wheel semantics.

This formulation makes three design choices explicit:

1. the proxy is conditioned by semantic class and category hierarchy;
2. the proxy is decomposed into a small graph of semantic parts;
3. the proxy is oriented and scaled by the detected silhouette or estimated footprint;
4. the geometry is intentionally constrained to a small number of primitives.

If the class is unknown, the system can fall back to a generic uncertainty volume, such as a translucent bounding box, ellipsoid, or vertical cylinder. This is operationally preferable to failing to render an object.

12 Implementation Status

To avoid overstating the current prototype, Table 9 separates implemented functionality from the full SPPA architecture.

Table 9: Current prototype versus full SPPA architecture.

Component	Current prototype	Full SPPA target
Semantic input	Single text label entered via batch script	Detection message with label, confidence, track ID, pose, bbox, mask, footprint, and uncertainty
Class handling	Exact templates plus keyword archetypes and generic fallback; out-of-template labels no longer abort, but unknown labels receive generic geometry	Reviewed ontology/cache with richer archetype descriptors and conservative display fallback
Geometry scaling	Fixed class-level proportions	Footprint-, silhouette-, and track-conditioned part scaling
Orientation	Template default orientation	Fused yaw from footprint, silhouette, velocity, and previous track
Runtime output	OBJ/MTL files for visual debugging	Compact primitive descriptor for instanced Unreal rendering
Evaluation	Per-object generation timing through batch/OBJ path	Latency, polygon budget, dense-scene FPS, footprint/volume error, recognition, and pilot-task metrics

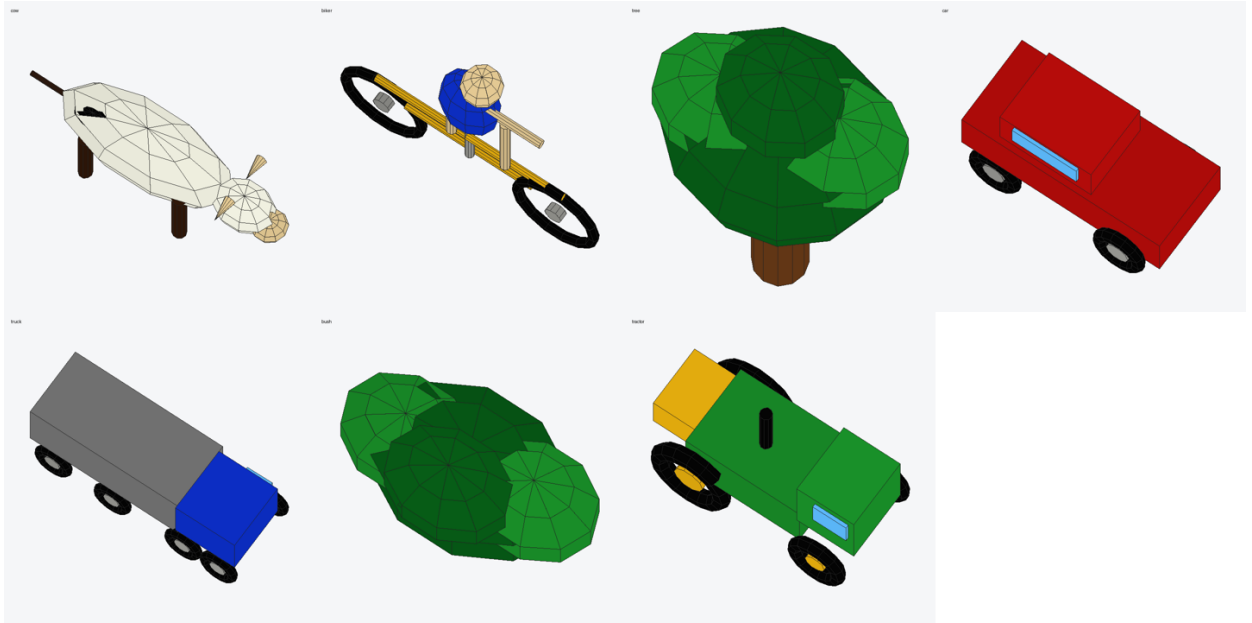


Figure 2: Example primitive proxies generated by the current prototype. The figures are deliberately low fidelity: their role is to communicate class, approximate orientation, and occupied volume with minimal geometry. In a runtime Unreal implementation, these proxies should be instantiated from primitive descriptors rather than loaded as high-detail meshes.

13 Prototype

We implemented a minimal procedural prototype named `XYT-xabi-yolo-telemetry`. The prototype receives a word from a Windows batch file and exports an OBJ/MTL mesh using only procedural geometry. The current supported classes include:

- `cow;`
- `biker;`
- `tree;`
- `car;`
- `truck;`
- `bush;`
- `tractor.`

This prototype is intentionally simple. The OBJ/MTL debug export path demonstrates the speed and geometry style of the approach, not a full UAV perception integration. In that debug path, each class is mapped to a fixed lightweight primitive template. The newer `SPPA-DESC-0.2` path accepts offline/CLI evidence such as bbox, mask polygon, world pose, yaw/heading, track id, source image size, and explicit metric dimensions. The Unreal plugin now includes an optional descriptor-ingestion API that builds primitive components from descriptor `parts[]` while leaving the curated-asset backend as the default. Open-label handling is implemented through exact templates, keyword archetypes, and a generic fallback, but that fallback has not been evaluated with operators or dense runtime scenes. In the full Pipeline B target (`PENDING-IMPL`), this descriptor path still needs live detections, calibrated geospatial footprints, packaged runtime profiling, and native dense-scene benchmarking.

14 Prototype Timing and Geometry Complexity

The prototype was measured by invoking the actual batch interface used by the operator. The observed wall-clock generation times and exported geometry sizes were:

Table 10: Prototype OBJ generation time and geometry complexity. These values measure the observed debug path only, not a deployed Unreal instancing runtime and not an end-to-end UAV/VR path.

Class	Time (s)	Vertices	Faces	OBJ bytes
biker	0.061	488	396	21,263
bush	0.081	256	210	10,888
car	0.062	448	408	20,268
cow	0.065	612	502	26,533
tractor	0.074	500	450	22,629
tree	0.062	288	236	12,308
truck	0.076	856	786	39,182

These values include Python process startup and file export overhead. They are reported only as debug-path observations. They do not establish the latency of a descriptor-based Unreal implementation, dense-scene rendering, headset frame rate, or detection-to-visible-actor latency. Those measurements are PENDING-BENCH. The relevant prototype result is modest: seven fixed low-polygon templates can be exported through the current batch/OBJ path in under 0.1 s per object.

15 Preliminary Fast 3D Generator Stress Test

Because recent image-to-3D systems are now fast enough to be plausible competitors, we ran a preliminary stress test against the subset of fast open-source generators that could be executed reproducibly in the current Windows workstation stack under a constrained portable-GPU profile. The purpose of this test is not to claim a visual advantage over neural generators. It is to test whether such generators can replace a bounded low-polygon runtime proxy inside an Unreal-based UAV digital twin.

The benchmark used the same six object classes as the current prototype: **cow**, **biker**, **tree**, **car**, **truck**, and **tractor**. SPPA received the class label. Legacy direct text baselines Point-E and Shap-E received the same prompt/tag field. TripoSR and Hunyuan3D received RGBA proxy crops generated from the same object set. All neural runs used the same desktop RTX 5090 workstation but with a 6 GB PyTorch CUDA allocator budget. This is not a physical GPU partition; it constrains PyTorch’s caching allocator to a fraction of visible device memory [26].

The 6 GB budget was chosen as a portable-flight stress profile rather than an arbitrary constraint. NVIDIA lists 24 GB, 16 GB, 12 GB, and 8 GB GDDR7 memory configurations across the 2026 RTX 50-series laptop family [21]. Epic’s Unreal Engine hardware guidance recommends 8 GB or more graphics RAM for UE5 development [9]. Steam’s May 2026 hardware survey reports VRAM shares of 8 GB (25.89%), 12 GB (12.77%), 16 GB (24.05%), 24 GB (5.22%), and 32 GB (1.20%) [34]. A 32 GB desktop RTX 5090 is therefore not a representative deployment assumption for a laptop that may simultaneously run Unreal, video, telemetry, and the generator.

The full logs, commands, process snapshots, and generated meshes are stored in the benchmark runs directory. The image/proxy run is 20260701_195624; the text/tag run is 20260701_text3d_prompt_baselines. Point-E and Shap-E are reported as legacy direct text/tag baselines. Point-E used the **base40M-textvec** model, 4,096 points, and SDF meshing at grid size 32; the reported time includes mesh conversion because Unreal cannot consume a point cloud as a conventional mesh actor without an additional representation layer. Shap-E used **text300M**, batch size 1, fp16

Table 11: Preliminary July 2026 stress test against fast open-source 3D generators under a 6 GB PyTorch allocator budget. This is a local operating-point stress test over six object classes, not a statistical benchmark or end-to-end UAV/VR validation.

Method	Condition	n	Reps	Input source	Median wall	Triangle range	Peak reserved	torch
SPPA template	current label only	6	1/object	class label	0.0016 s	488–1,668	0 MB	
Legacy text, $K = 16$	Shap-E label only	6	1/object	prompt/tag	2.0080 s	17,884–131,668	6,120 MB	
Legacy text + SDF32	Point-E label only	6	1/object	prompt/tag	6.4266 s	1,026–5,454	3,644 MB	
TripoSR 128 ³ extraction	warm, clean proxy crop	6	1/object	RGBA image	proxy 0.4604 s	19,284–31,012	2,028 MB	
Hunyuan3D-2mini Turbo, 5 steps	clean proxy crop	6	1/object	RGBA image	proxy 1.5042 s	332,020–1,698,032	6,092 max	MB

sampling, and $K = 16$ Karras steps. This is a speed-oriented setting rather than Shap-E’s higher-step notebook example, so it should not be read as best-quality Shap-E.

TripoSR [32] was run at marching-cubes resolution 128 and used a local CPU PyMCubes fallback because the upstream `torchmcubes` CUDA extension did not compile on the Windows, PyTorch, and CUDA stack used here. Hunyuan3D-2mini Turbo used five inference steps, octree resolution 380, and FlashVDM. The inspected Hunyuan3D local text route first invokes a text-to-image model and then shape generation; if benchmarked, it should be reported as text-to-image-to-3D, not as a direct tag-to-mesh baseline. Stable Fast 3D compiled only under a Python 3.10/Torch 2.8 environment in this workstation and its warm benchmark did not emit a model-load event within 20 minutes, so it is treated as unresolved rather than reported as a failed quality result. SPAR3D installed in the same Python 3.10/Torch 2.8 stack after dependency pinning, but model loading failed with a gated-repository access error for `stabilityai/stable-point-aware-3d`; it is therefore also unresolved in this pass.

For qualitative inspection, both runs also store orthographic front, side, top, and isometric views for each generated mesh in their `views` directories. These images are not used as quantitative evidence. They are an audit artifact for checking whether each method preserves a useful footprint, frontal/lateral extent, and top-down occupancy under the kinds of changing viewpoints encountered during flight. Dense neural meshes are sampled for visualization only; the triangle counts in Table 11 are measured from the original mesh files.

These results narrow the claim. SPPA is not a general high-fidelity 3D asset generator. TripoSR and Hunyuan3D are far more appropriate when visual reconstruction from a usable crop is the target, and Shap-E shows that text-conditioned meshes can be produced in seconds under a fast sampling configuration. However, the preliminary data are consistent with the operational distinction motivating SPPA: class-conditioned primitive proxies can be generated in milliseconds, without GPU inference, and with bounded low-polygon geometry. The open question is therefore not whether SPPA should replace neural generation visually; it should not. The open question is whether bounded primitive descriptors are the right runtime representation when the UAV system needs a persistent track object whose pose, scale, yaw, and uncertainty can be updated every frame under a shared Unreal/VR GPU budget. That remains `PENDING-EXP` and `PENDING-BENCH`.

16 Open-Label And Lightweight Baseline Measurements

Following the zero-trust audit, we added an open-label resolution path to the prototype and to the Unreal/Porc SPPA actor. The implementation now separates three cases: exact implemented labels, keyword-resolved archetypes, and generic unknown-label fallback. This is not a claim that every out-of-template word receives a correct object-specific mesh. It is only a measured claim that out-of-template labels no longer abort the SPPA path and instead produce either an archetype proxy or a conservative generic proxy.

A smoke batch with four labels produced the following outcomes: `car` resolved as `exact_class` with 864 triangles; `ambulance` resolved as `keyword_archetype/light_vehicle` with 864 triangles; `antenna` resolved as `keyword_archetype/vertical_structure` with 90 triangles; and `mystery_object` resolved as `fallback_unknown_label` with 94 triangles. The measured artifact is stored under `experiments/sppa_open_label_smoke`.

We also compared SPPA against deliberately cheap procedural baselines. These baselines are important because they are the real runtime competitors for a flight laptop: boxes, ellipsoids, capsule-like proxies, and billboards, not only neural text/image-to-3D generators. Table 12 reports 50 in-memory construction repetitions per class over six labels. OBJ export was performed once per method/class for geometry inspection.

Table 12: Lightweight procedural baselines over six classes. These are local Python construction timings, not Unreal frame times. Lower dimension error means closer AABB match to the target synthetic dimensions.

Method	n	P50 build ms	P95 build ms	Triangles	Mean dim. error
Billboard	6	0.0007	0.0011	2–2	0.3333
Box	6	0.0046	0.0058	12–12	0.0000
Capsule proxy	6	0.0585	0.0685	212–212	0.0081
Ellipsoid	6	0.0372	0.0447	144–144	0.0000
SPPA fixed	6	0.2924	0.3563	488–1668	0.2852
SPPA global-scaled	6	0.4575	0.4963	488–1668	0.0000
SPPA parametric	6	0.2902	0.3285	488–1692	0.1589

The result weakens any simplistic speed claim. SPPA is slower than a box or billboard. Its defensible argument from this Python OBJ debug benchmark is restricted to retaining class-level part structure at low local construction cost; it is not Unreal, packaged, or VR frame-time evidence. Whether that structure helps operator recognition or occupied-volume judgement is still `PENDING-USER`.

We separately measured synthetic within-class scale variants, including compact and long vehicles. This tests only explicit-dimension adaptation, not silhouette fitting from real UAV images. Table 13 separates a trivial global-scaling SPPA baseline from the implemented parametric vehicle rule. Global scaling removes AABB error by definition, but it also scales cab, wheels, windows, and body together. The parametric rule does not optimize for zero AABB error; it preserves bounded part roles while changing the parts that should absorb length changes. A box remains the lower-cost geometry-fit baseline; SPPA must justify its extra triangles through recognizability and part semantics, not by claiming a raw AABB fit win.

Table 13: Synthetic scale-variant benchmark. This measures explicit-dimension adaptation only, not mask fitting or real image adaptation. The vehicle-only rows are the fair test for the implemented parametric vehicle grammar; other archetypes remain template-prior or fallback paths.

Method	n variants	Median dim. error	Median build ms	Triangles
SPPA fixed, all archetypes	12	0.3350	0.2941	488–1668
SPPA global-scaled, all archetypes	12	0.0000	0.4619	488–1668
SPPA parametric, all archetypes	12	0.2170	0.2928	488–1692
Box, all archetypes	12	0.0000	0.0045	12–12
SPPA fixed, vehicles only	4	0.3926	0.4201	864–1668
SPPA global-scaled, vehicles only	4	0.0000	0.6401	864–1668
SPPA parametric, vehicles only	4	0.0223	0.3448	864–1692
Box, vehicles only	4	0.0000	0.0045	12–12

As a controlled part-invariance check, two truck descriptors with equal width/height and different length keep cab scale fixed at $[1.656, 2.070, 1.952]$ m and wheel scale fixed at $[0.392, 0.094]$ m, while the cargo/body length changes from 2.263 m to 5.188 m. This is still a deterministic layout prior, not evidence that SPPA recovers true truck morphology from imagery.

Table 14: Debug-path material ablation. The benchmark isolates construction, OBJ/MTL export, and material-manifest overhead. It is not a dense Unreal frame-time benchmark, not a perceptual-discriminability test, and not a user study.

Method	Classes	Reps	Build P50	Build P95	Export P50	Export P95	Manifest P50	Manifest P95	Materials	Triangles
sppa_flat	6	50	0.3562	0.4139	0.8047	0.9000	0.0007	0.0009	1-1	488-1668
sppa_class_color	6	50	0.3569	0.3784	0.8019	0.8864	0.0006	0.0008	1-1	488-1668
sppa_part_material	6	50	0.3566	0.4167	0.8073	0.8760	0.2311	0.2749	3-5	488-1668
sppa_part_material_metadata_low_conf	6	50	0.3568	0.4155	0.8071	0.8810	0.2284	0.2631	3-5	488-1668

The table reports medians across six class-level medians after 50 repeated runs per class/method. Not measured: Unreal frame time, draw calls, material-instance cost, dense-scene scaling, perceptual discriminability, or user recognition/workload.

17 Unreal/Porce Backend Switch Smoke Test

The Porce Unreal integration was rebuilt with UE 5.7 and tested with the backend verification script. The smoke test checks four properties: the backend enum contains asset spawning and semantic proxy modes; the default mode is asset spawning; explicit backend selection reaches both modes; and the UI toggle path returns to the opposite mode. The report records the enum values as `UNREAL_ASSETS` and `SEMANTIC_PROXY`.

The same test also spawns `APorceSemanticProxyActor` for `bike`, `cow`, `tower`, `car`, `ambulance`, `tree`, `antenna`, `mystery_object`, and `unknown`. The generated mesh-component counts were 6, 7, 4, 7, 7, 5, 4, 3, and 3 respectively. The script path is `tools/verify_sppa_backend.ps1`.

This test is important for scope control: SPPA is optional and does not replace the existing asset-spawning path. It is also not a dense-runtime benchmark. The artifacts are `pipeline/logs/sppa_backend_verify_latest.json` and `pipeline/logs/sppa_backend_verify_latest.log`. Native frame-time, draw-call, and headset results remain `PENDING-BENCH`.

18 Evidence-Calibrated Material Cues

Material-cue extension. We implemented a bounded material-cue extension after the reviewer-style risk analysis. It is not texture or PBR asset generation. Each proxy part receives a material role, an evidence-source tag, and an uncertainty-style tag. Python exports these cues through MTL comments and a JSON material manifest. Unreal reflects the same contract through component tags for role, evidence source, and uncertainty style. The cues are semantic priors or explicit unknown fallbacks; they are not claimed to be observed textures unless a future sensor/operator source explicitly provides that evidence.

The Unreal smoke test was extended to fail if generated proxy parts lack material-role, evidence-source, or uncertainty-style tags. The latest report records the evidence-material switch, material-policy actor tags, semantic-prior tags for known/archetype classes, and fallback-unknown plus warning-marker tags for unknown classes. The supporting artifacts are the material-cycle note, the ablation run directory, and the latest backend verification report.

19 Operational Claim To Be Tested

The scientific contribution is not a new high-fidelity 3D generator. The testable claim is instead:

For telemetry-driven UAV digital twins, class-conditioned primitive assemblies may provide a bounded, uncertainty-aware, intended pilot-facing obstacle volume when a curated asset is unavailable or too costly to render.

This is a `PENDING-EXP` claim. It must be evaluated empirically through generation latency, polygon and draw-call budget, dense-scene VR frame rate, operator recognition of class and occupied volume, navigation usefulness under degraded video, unknown-class fallback behavior, and bandwidth comparison against encoded video, telemetry-only boxes, and full-mesh transfer.

19.1 Temporal Update Policy

SPPA should not be evaluated as if a complete mesh must be regenerated at every video frame. The intended deployable policy is track-persistent. When a stable detection track appears, the system instantiates or compiles one proxy. During subsequent frames, the runtime updates pose, scale, velocity, uncertainty, and visibility state from the shared telemetry/detection stream. Geometry is regenerated or swapped only when the class, archetype, dimensions, or confidence state crosses a predefined threshold. For static objects, most frames should therefore be transform updates rather than geometry-generation events. For rigid moving objects, geometry can remain resident while pose and yaw are updated. For articulated or shape-changing objects, the descriptor needs parametric parts or explicit shape-update events. The current Unreal actor rejects shape-update packets that contain only a global scale and requires replacement part parameters for shape updates, avoiding silent root-scale deformation of wheels, cabs, or other semantic subparts. The dense replay policy, thresholds, and visual consequences remain PENDING-EXP.

This policy is part of the comparison with image-to-3D generators. A changing UAV viewpoint does not, by itself, require SPPA to regenerate the object if the object identity and dimensions are stable. A neural image-to-3D baseline can also be generated once and instanced if a stable tracking/fusion layer is available. If it is used directly from changing per-frame crops, repeated generation may be required; if it is generated once, the benchmark must include the tracking/fusion layer, asset cache, decimation/LOD, and uncertainty handling. The fair benchmark must therefore report both one-time generation/instantiation cost and per-frame update cost.

Table 15: Timing taxonomy for the current evidence. The rows measure different artifacts and must not be interpreted as native Unreal/VR frame-time evidence.

Measurement	What it measures	n	Reported result	Not evidence for
SPPA stress-test row	Current batch template path over six labels	6	median 0.0016 s	Unreal spawn/update cost
In-memory template creation	Python procedural object construction	60,000	P50 177.2 μ s	Mesh export or rendering
Debug OBJ/MTL export	File-based prototype export path	600	P50 1.076 ms	Instanced primitive runtime
Policy/state update	Offline track-state update during log replay	436,652	P50 0.4 μ s	Render-thread or GPU cost

19.2 Implemented Descriptor and Update-Packet Benchmark

After the first reviewer-driven correction cycle, the Python generator emits a versioned geometry/track descriptor separate from the material manifest. The descriptor records source label, archetype resolution, bbox/mask/world-pose evidence, yaw provenance, yaw ambiguity, scale source, primitive parts, cost fields, and scheduler thresholds. A companion update packet distinguishes creation, pose updates, shape-parameter updates, topology regeneration, low-confidence drops, and no-ops. This is implemented in Python and benchmarked offline. Native Unreal descriptor ingestion is now implemented as an optional actor path and verified by reflection/smoke tests, but the benchmark in this subsection is still a Python contract benchmark rather than Unreal frame-time.

The smoke set generated descriptors for six exact classes, three keyword-based open labels, and three unsupported labels. All exact and keyword labels resolved to known archetypes; all unsupported labels produced explicit unknown fallback descriptors. This demonstrates bounded open-label routing, not universal word-to-3D generation.

Scheduler sensitivity was evaluated at shape thresholds 0.05, 0.10, 0.20, and 0.30. In the synthetic sequences, shape updates decreased from five events at 0.05 to one event at 0.20–0.30. In the stratified replay subset, seven logs contributed up to 3,000 observations each, with the smallest log contributing 2,392 observations. The resulting 20,392 base observations produced 81,568 threshold-expanded rows. Shape updates decreased from 2,106 events at threshold 0.05

Table 16: Preliminary SPPA-DESC-0.2/SPPA-UPD-0.2 benchmark. Times are Python contract and scheduler measurements, not Unreal frame-time.

Measurement	n	P50	P95	P99
Synthetic descriptor build with parts	160	221.1 μs	478.4 μs	570.9 μs
Synthetic scheduler decision	160	4.0 μs	10.1 μs	12.5 μs
Synthetic update-packet build	160	9.7 μs	56.6 μs	80.3 μs
Synthetic create total, Python only	20	513.4 μs	1,503.9 μs	1,552.9 μs
Synthetic pose/no-op update, no mesh	140	13.7 μs	28.3 μs	37.3 μs
Synthetic full descriptor size	160	6,262 B	8,200 B	8,201 B
Synthetic update packet size	160	943 B	4,659 B	6,584 B
Replay descriptor build with parts	81,568	316.1 μs	395.0 μs	433.0 μs
Replay scheduler decision	81,568	6.1 μs	9.9 μs	12.1 μs
Replay update-packet build	81,568	14.9 μs	21.1 μs	73.5 μs
Replay pose/no-op update, no mesh	80,156	21.2 μs	27.8 μs	32.1 μs
Replay update packet size	81,568	1,045 B	1,395 B	4,966 B

to 738 events at threshold 0.30; creates remained fixed at 353 per threshold and no topology regenerations occurred in this subset. One create-total timing outlier reached 243 ms, so P95/P99 are more informative than the maximum for this Python microbenchmark. This sensitivity must be preregistered for future experiments because threshold choice directly changes update frequency. The replay remains policy-derived from logs, not native Unreal actor instrumentation.

19.3 Unreal Descriptor-Ingestion Smoke Test

After implementing `ConfigureProxyFromDescriptorJson`, the Unreal `PorcTelemetry` plugin was rebuilt with Unreal Engine 5.7 and verified with the existing reflection smoke harness. The test keeps `UnrealAssets` as the default backend and verifies that the backend UI switch still toggles between curated assets and semantic proxies. For the descriptor path, the smoke harness loads a real SPPA-DESC-0.2 fixture from the atomic descriptor benchmark and calls the native actor API. The fixture `sppa-8d4e38132a285493` contains 12 parts; Unreal generated 12 static-mesh components and attached `SPPA_MATERIAL_ROLE`, `SPPA_EVIDENCE_SOURCE`, and `SPPA_UNCERTAINTY_STYLE` component tags. The same smoke verified that invalid JSON is rejected without changing the current proxy, that descriptor reconfiguration changes the part count, and that a pose-update packet is accepted for an existing descriptor proxy without rebuilding topology. A pose-update packet with a mismatched `descriptor_id` is rejected by the actor-level smoke test.

This closes the earlier implementation gap between the Python descriptor and the Unreal semantic-proxy backend. It does not establish packaged-build performance, VR frame rate, draw calls, GPU cost, dense-scene behavior, or operator benefit. Those remain `PENDING-BENCH` and `PENDING-USER`.

19.4 Unreal Actor-Level Microbenchmark

We then measured the native actor path in Unreal Editor-Cmd mode. The benchmark creates transient actors directly through the Unreal Python API, applies five pose updates per actor, applies one shape update, and destroys the actors. It uses the same descriptor fixtures saved by the Python descriptor benchmark and compares six baselines: no rendering, billboard label, box

proxy, ellipsoid proxy, the legacy semantic proxy, and descriptor-driven SPPA. The run used 10, 50, 100, 250, and 500 actors with ten repetitions per count. The artifact directory is `experiments/sppa_unreal_backend/20260702T084924Z_editor_actor_microbenchmark`.

Table 17: Preliminary Unreal Editor-Cmd actor microbenchmark. Times are per-object p50/p95 milliseconds across 50 rows per method. The p95 values are descriptive rather than a final latency guarantee. This is not a packaged build, not a `/api/ui/data` replay, not render-thread timing, and not VR frame-time evidence.

Method	Components at 500	Create P50	Create P95	Pose P50	Pose P95	Shape P50	Shape P95
<code>no_render</code>	0	0.0029	0.0034	0.00009	0.00012	0.00000	0.00002
<code>billboard_label</code>	0	0.2915	0.4184	0.0087	0.0102	0.00012	0.00026
<code>box_proxy</code>	500	0.3619	0.4619	0.0120	0.0128	0.0091	0.0102
<code>ellipsoid_proxy</code>	500	0.3456	0.4518	0.0087	0.0094	0.0054	0.0065
<code>legacy_semantic_proxy</code>	2180	0.6110	0.8250	0.0149	0.0195	0.0135	0.0216
<code>sppa_desc</code>	2680	0.9689	3.9896	0.0287	0.0503	0.0316	0.0502

The manifest reports no exceptions and zero internal row failures for create, pose, shape, or no-op actions. All rows reused both component count and component names during pose and shape updates. The result is deliberately not presented as a latency victory over trivial boxes or ellipsoids: those baselines are faster and use far fewer components. The measured SPPA claim supported by this microbenchmark is narrower: a richer semantic part actor can be created around 1 ms per object at the median in this Editor-Cmd setup and updated without component reconstruction at roughly 0.03 ms per object at the median. The SPPA create-time p95 is much higher than the median in this run, so packaged replay, warm/cold cache separation, and frame-time measurement are still required. Whether the additional semantic structure changes operator recognition or remains acceptable in a packaged dense VR scene is still `PENDING-USER` and `PENDING-BENCH`.

19.5 Component Payload Replay

To move one step closer to the actual telemetry lifecycle, we added a debug entry point on `UPorcedTelemetryComponent` that applies a JSON payload with the same `obstacles[]` shape used by `/api/ui/data`, but without HTTP. This benchmark exercises component parsing, entity upsert, backend selection, actor spawning, descriptor/update packet routing, pose updates, and shape updates. It compares the default asset backend against the semantic-proxy backend using the same obstacle payload. In this preliminary run the asset backend uses `StaticMeshActor` placeholders rather than the project curated asset library, so it is a lifecycle baseline, not a final visual-asset comparison.

The run used 10, 50, 100, 250, and 500 actors, ten repetitions per count, and five pose-update batches per actor. The run identifier is `20260702T085905Z`; artifacts are stored under the component-replay experiment directory. The benchmark order was not randomized, cold and warm cache behavior were not separated, and p95 values should be read as descriptive preliminary tails from ten repetitions per size rather than as operational tail latency guarantees.

Table 18: Preliminary component payload replay using the `/api/ui/data`-style obstacle payload shape. Times are per-object p50/p95 milliseconds across 50 rows per backend, with per-size summaries retained as artifacts. This bypasses HTTP and does not measure packaged-build, render-thread, GPU, draw-call, or VR frame-time cost.

Backend	Components at 500	Create P50	Create P95	Pose P50	Pose P95	Shape P50	Shape P95
<code>UnrealAssets</code> placeholder	500	0.5116	0.9882	0.0226	0.0447	0.0323	0.0703
<code>SemanticProxy/SPPA-DESC</code>	2680	1.2892	1.6423	0.0426	0.0531	0.0683	0.0829

The manifest reports no failures. This result supports only a narrow lifecycle claim: the same obstacle payload shape can drive both backends, and the SPPA component path remains low-millisecond per actor for creation and below 0.1 ms per actor for pose/shape updates at p95

in this Editor-Cmd replay. The table aggregates all tested scene sizes; per-size summaries and component-identity traces are stored as benchmark artifacts. The SPPA path also used many more components than the placeholder asset path (2680 vs. 500 at 500 actors), so the benchmark must not be interpreted as render scalability or visual-quality equivalence. It does not settle the final runtime question because it bypasses HTTP; the next subsection closes only the local polling-path gap, while the real curated assets, packaged execution, render-thread/GPU work, and VR presentation remain unmeasured.

19.6 HTTP Poll Replay Through the Unreal Component

We next exercised the Unreal HTTP polling branch with a local loopback server that served the same `/api/ui/data` obstacle payload shape. The component used a debug-only blocking helper, `PollNowBlockingForTest`, so the run could deterministically wait for each Unreal HTTP-module response inside Editor-Cmd. Normal runtime polling remains asynchronous. This benchmark covers HTTP request dispatch, response parsing, component batch ingestion, backend selection, actor spawning, descriptor/update packet routing, pose updates, and shape updates. It still does not cover a live flight server, real network jitter, packaged execution, render-thread/GPU work, draw calls, or VR presentation.

The valid run identifier is 20260702T101020Z; artifacts are stored in the HTTP poll replay experiment directory. The run loaded 52 descriptor fixtures with input hash 459d477d66f5b9af, used 10, 50, 100, 250, and 500 actors, ten repetitions per size, and five pose-update batches per actor. The manifest reports no failures; the row artifacts contain 1050 HTTP GET requests. The run uses seed 20260702 and interleaves backend order within each count/repetition group through a rotated/reversed counterbalanced schedule. The schedule and actual execution order are stored as `http_poll_replay_schedule.jsonl` and `http_poll_replay_order_trace.csv`. Benchmark garbage collection is requested before each condition, but cold and warm cache behavior are still not separated. In addition to the two operational spawn backends, the run includes a `no_render` debug baseline that parses the same HTTP payloads and updates component entity state while disabling actor spawning through a test-only flag. This baseline is not exposed as an operational UI backend. The run also emits paired incremental-delta artifacts comparing `UnrealAssets` and `SemanticProxy` against the same `no_render` component-lifecycle baseline and against each other. The same run emits `sppa_runtime_update_trace.csv`, `sppa_runtime_update_trace.jsonl`, and `sppa_runtime_update_summary.json`, which record resolver match type, scale/material source, uncertainty tags, descriptor identity, component reuse, and component creation/destruction counts around each create, pose-update, shape-update, or no-op payload. An earlier run that accidentally loaded only one descriptor fixture was discarded and is not used in the reported numbers.

Table 19: Preliminary local-loopback HTTP poll replay through `UPorceTelemetryComponent`. Times are per-object p50/p95 milliseconds across 50 rows per backend. This is an Editor-Cmd replay through the Unreal HTTP module, not a packaged-build, render-thread, GPU, draw-call, or VR frame-time benchmark.

Backend	Components at 500	Create P50	Create P95	Pose P50	Pose P95	Shape P50	Shape P95
NoRender debug	0	0.6577	1.3239	0.2209	0.6223	0.1425	0.5688
UnrealAssets placeholder	500	0.7129	1.3484	0.2681	0.6947	0.1477	0.6172
SemanticProxy/SPPA-DESC	2680	1.4897	2.4012	0.4068	0.8706	0.2250	0.6963

Table 20: Batch-level local-loopback HTTP poll replay by scene size. Create and shape columns report one HTTP poll with ten repetitions per size/backend. Pose columns report raw pose-update HTTP polls, five per repetition, for 50 pose polls per size/backend. Values are p50/p95 milliseconds; p95 is descriptive rather than a robust tail-latency estimate.

Backend	Actors	Create poll	Pose poll	Shape poll
NoRender	10	11.8/13.5	5.7/6.8	5.6/7.5
NoRender	50	32.9/36.2	12.3/14.3	8.9/10.4
NoRender	100	63.5/67.1	20.4/23.2	14.2/15.9
NoRender	250	159.2/163.0	45.5/48.6	29.9/32.0
NoRender	500	329.8/367.0	87.9/104.1	55.8/65.1
UnrealAssets	10	12.1/14.6	6.1/7.2	5.9/6.4
UnrealAssets	50	34.1/39.1	12.2/14.7	9.9/11.7
UnrealAssets	100	69.5/72.7	21.5/23.7	14.8/16.9
UnrealAssets	250	172.4/187.2	47.1/50.6	31.4/33.7
UnrealAssets	500	357.4/371.6	91.5/96.8	58.5/66.4
SemanticProxy	10	22.7/24.7	6.8/8.3	6.8/7.6
SemanticProxy	50	74.2/77.3	17.4/19.0	13.5/14.1
SemanticProxy	100	146.2/150.7	29.4/31.8	22.1/30.1
SemanticProxy	250	367.4/391.7	68.0/72.3	49.0/52.4
SemanticProxy	500	738.6/839.3	134.0/142.3	95.4/112.5

Table 21: Paired incremental batch deltas at 500 actors from the same local-loopback HTTP replay. Entries report p50 delta and mean delta with bootstrap 95% confidence interval in milliseconds. Negative or near-zero deltas in the **UnrealAssets** rows indicate measurement noise around the shared HTTP/JSON/entity-state path; the table should be read as preliminary component-path overhead, not as stage timing or rendering cost.

Comparison	Create Δ		Pose Δ		Shape Δ	Δ components
UnrealAssets-NoRender	24.5	[28.7; 9.3, 45.5]	1.1	[2.1; -1.0, 4.7]	0.9 [2.9; 0.4, 5.8]	500
SPPA-NoRender	413.9	[424.8; 401.1, 452.2]	45.5	[44.8; 42.2, 47.7]	40.1 [40.8; 37.0, 44.5]	2680
SPPA-UnrealAssets	387.8	[396.1; 371.7, 419.8]	40.8	[42.7; 40.3, 45.0]	37.9 [37.8; 35.2, 40.5]	2180

Table 22: Runtime update trace for the **SemanticProxy** backend in the same HTTP poll replay. Counts aggregate entity-level trace rows across all scene sizes and repetitions. The trace is actor/component instrumentation, not render-thread or GPU timing.

Phase	Rows	Created	Reused	Destroyed	Fallback	Yaw ambig.	Scale-source	rows
Create	2,950	24,740	0	0	550	2,950	690	metric / 2,260
Pose update	45,500	0	246,700	0	2,750	45,500	34,200	metric / 11,300
Shape update	9,100	0	49,340	0	550	9,100	6,840	metric / 2,260

This result is intentionally interpreted narrowly. It shows that the same HTTP-pollled obstacle payload can drive both backends and that descriptor-driven SPPA actors can be created and updated through the Unreal component without reported request or parsing failures in a local Editor-Cmd replay. It does not show a latency advantage over asset spawning, because the placeholder asset backend is faster for creation and uses fewer components. The no-render row also shows that large payload parsing and entity-state bookkeeping already consume a substantial part of the batch cost, especially at 500 actors. The SPPA-specific increment is therefore not the whole HTTP-poll cost, but the paired 500-actor deltas show an additional median create cost of 387.8 ms relative to the placeholder asset backend and an additional median pose-poll cost of 40.8 ms before rendering is measured. The new runtime trace supports a narrower but important implementation claim: pose and shape payloads update resident components without topology reconstruction, and resolver/fallback/yaw uncertainty metadata remain visible as actor tags. This table still does not show dense-scene render viability: at 500 actors, one SPPA create poll is hundreds of milliseconds in this replay, and one pose-update poll is over 100 ms before any render-thread or GPU cost is

measured. The 500-actor SPPA case also contains 2680 generated components. Packaged runtime, real curated assets, networked telemetry, render-thread/GPU timing, and operator interpretation remain `PENDING-BENCH` and `PENDING-USER`.

19.7 Packaged Internal Render Benchmark

We then added an opt-in packaged benchmark runner to the Unreal plugin. The runner is activated only by the command-line flag `-PorceSPPAPackagedBenchmark`; normal AeroTwin maps and telemetry paths are otherwise unchanged. The benchmark packages the project, launches the executable, loads a dedicated empty benchmark map, and applies synthetic obstacle batches through the telemetry component batch API. This is an internal packaged replay with rendered frames, not live HTTP telemetry and not VR headset execution. The clean 2026-07-02 run is stored under run identifier `20260702T122743Z_packaged_render`; the packaging smoke run identifier is `20260702T122702Z_packaged_render`. Full artifact paths and commands are recorded in `docs/sppa_packaged_render_benchmark_20260702.md`.

Table 23: Packaged Unreal internal render benchmark, 100 synthetic obstacles, three repetitions, 30 warmup frames and 120 measured frames per phase. Frame times are Tick delta p50/p95 milliseconds. Draw calls and triangles are estimated from static mesh components, not GPU profiler counters. The `unreal_assets` backend uses a simple packaged placeholder actor, not the curated project asset library.

Backend	Components	Triangles	Draws	Create frame P95	Pose frame P95	Shape frame P95	Create apply P50
<code>no_render</code>	0	0	0	4.072	4.140	4.176	0.974
<code>unreal_assets</code>	100	4,800	100	4.414	5.227	4.810	5.952
<code>semantic_proxy</code>	432	208,864	432	4.817	17.814	19.256	46.067

The benchmark produced no benchmark-level failures, and the dedicated map avoided unrelated `BP_OpenSkyManager` HTTP polling observed in an earlier smoke attempt. Across the tested 10, 50, and 100 object densities, all SPPA phases stayed below 33.3 ms p95 in this packaged desktop run. However, the 100-object SPPA pose and shape update streams exceeded a 16.7 ms p95 frame budget, and SPPA had much higher create-apply cost than the placeholder asset backend because it builds many more primitive components. Therefore the allowed claim is limited: the current descriptor-driven semantic proxy can run in a packaged executable for 100 synthetic obstacles under a 30 FPS p95 budget on the tested desktop, but it is not yet a demonstrated VR/headset, live-network, or curated-asset result. Unreal CSV profiler was smoke-tested, but the generated profiler CSV was zero bytes on immediate process exit; GPU profiler counters are therefore still

`PENDING-BENCH`.

19.8 Preliminary Track-Lifecycle Measurement

To avoid overstating this policy, we measured only what the current artifacts can support. First, the current Python procedural template builder was executed 10,000 times per implemented class. Second, seven available controller `obstacle_ingest` logs were replayed offline to derive policy-implied create, update, shape-update, and topology-regeneration events. These logs contain 436,652 recorded track observations and 5,546 observed tracks. Three of the logs are explicitly marked `SIMULATION/AUTONOMOUS`; several older logs do not record workflow metadata. Some logs also mark obstacle samples as truncated. The result is therefore a preliminary lifecycle audit, not a native Unreal frame-time trace and not a final real-flight validation.

Under the track-persistent policy, the replay produced 5,546 create events, 410,766 pose and confidence updates, 20,340 shape and scale parameter updates, and zero topology-regeneration events. This zero should not be overinterpreted. It means that, in the recorded samples and under the declared policy, no track changed class or archetype in a way that required rebuilding the proxy topology. If the current non-parametric file-export path were used naively, the 20,340 shape

Table 24: Preliminary SPPA lifecycle costs from the current Python template builder and available controller obstacle-track logs. Update costs are descriptor/state updates only; Unreal actor transform and render-thread costs remain PENDING-BENCH.

Metric	n	P50	P95	P99
In-memory proxy creation	60,000	177.2 μ s	403.7 μ s	663.5 μ s
Debug OBJ/MTL export path	600	1.076 ms	1.522 ms	1.745 ms
Policy/state update per track observation	436,652	0.4 μ s	0.8 μ s	1.3 μ s

and scale changes would become a conservative full-rebuild upper bound. The publishable claim is therefore narrower: SPPA can in principle amortize object creation over track lifetime, but a final paper still needs native Unreal instrumentation for actor create, update, reconfigure, despawn, and frame-time impact.

20 Preregistered Evaluation Protocol

For a Q1-level validation, SPPA must be evaluated as an operational representation, not as a visual asset generator. The central comparison is against representation choices that a UAV digital twin would realistically use: no rendering, 3D bounding boxes, generic capsules or ellipsoids, billboard labels, curated low-poly assets when available, procedural actors, occupancy style volumes, and SPPA.

A minimal publishable benchmark should include both synthetic scale variants and real or simulated UAV-view detections. Synthetic variants test whether the same semantic graph adapts to different proportions, such as a short truck versus a long truck. UAV-view detections test the harder case: imperfect bounding boxes, partial silhouettes, top-down perspectives, and uncertain yaw. The evaluation must report failure cases, including occlusion, truncated detections, ambiguous front/back orientation, unknown classes, and misleading confidence displays.

21 Threats to Validity

Primitive proxies can misrepresent fine geometry, pose, articulation, and object-specific hazards. A proxy cow or tractor is not a true reconstruction of the observed object. The visual style may also create false confidence: a clean proxy can look more certain than the underlying detector, georeference, or scale estimate. This must be tested with uncertainty visualization rather than assumed.

Top-down UAV viewpoints, occlusion, motion blur, image compression, and partial detections can remove the evidence needed for part placement or signed yaw. The yaw model therefore exposes yaw_ambiguous, but the thresholds and display behavior are PENDING-SPEC. Template bias is another risk: the seven current classes are too small to support broad claims about arbitrary semantic labels.

Language-guided semantic compilation introduces hallucination and certification risk. A language model may propose an implausible part graph for rare or ambiguous labels. SPPA must therefore review language-derived mappings against a finite archetype library, dimension priors, polygon budgets, and conservative fallback rules before runtime use. This review protocol is

PENDING-SPEC.

Finally, runtime performance is hardware- and engine-dependent. Triangle count alone does not predict headset frame rate, draw-call pressure, material cost, or tracking comfort. All dense-scene claims remain PENDING-BENCH.

22 Evidence Needed For Full System Validation

23 Reproducibility Notes

The benchmark directories store command logs, event JSONL files, object-level CSVs, GPU snapshots, process snapshots, generated meshes, and rendered contact sheets. The descriptor/update contract benchmark directory stores CSV rows, JSONL descriptor samples, a JSON summary, and a Markdown report. The text/image-to-3D dependency worktrees and model caches are machine-local and git-ignored because they contain large repositories and model weights. A submission-ready artifact still needs a clean committed source state or archived patch hash, model hashes, environment lock files, and permanent copies of the exact source snapshots used for each generator. SF3D and SPAR3D remain unresolved in this local pass because one timed out during warm loading and the other required model access that was not available. These unresolved baselines are recorded as setup/access outcomes, not as quality failures.

The 6 GB GPU budget is implemented through PyTorch’s allocator fraction. It is a portable-flight stress profile, not a hard GPU partition and not a guarantee that Unreal, video decoding, tracking, and generation can all co-reside at that budget without native profiling. The benchmark also uses clean synthetic/proxy RGBA inputs for image-to-3D methods; degraded UAV crops, compression, occlusion, small object size, and motion blur remain PENDING-BENCH.

24 Limitations

The current prototype is class-template based and does not infer volumetric scale from a real detection pipeline. It does not consume live YOLO tracks, instance masks, calibrated camera geometry, georeferenced footprints, or uncertainty estimates as an end-to-end flight loop. Unreal can now ingest an optional descriptor and construct primitive components from `parts[]`, and this path has been exercised through reflection/smoke tests, Editor-Cmd actor and component replays, local-loopback HTTP replay, and a packaged internal render benchmark. It has not been benchmarked in a VR headset, live-network telemetry loop, or curated-asset operational scene. The current timings measure debug OBJ export, Python descriptor construction, Unreal actor operations, and packaged synthetic replay; they do not yet establish final instanced primitive or headset runtime performance.

The paper also does not include a pilot or user study. Claims about operator readability, situation awareness, workload, or navigation usefulness remain hypotheses until evaluated. The specified fallback behavior is implemented as a Python/Unreal smoke-tested display fallback, but it is not yet shown to reduce operator error, false confidence, or operational risk.

The next step is to connect the proxy generator to YOLO detections, instance masks or bounding boxes, UAV pose, camera calibration, georeferenced placement, and dense Unreal runtime benchmarking. The contribution becomes publishable only if it is evaluated under the intended operational constraints: remote piloting, degraded video links, semantic telemetry, and VR real-time rendering.

25 Conclusion

SPPA, as presented here, is a specification for a semantic proxy rendering layer for telemetry-driven UAV digital twins. Static asset libraries may be incomplete or operationally expensive for long-tail detections, and neural image-to-3D systems optimize asset fidelity rather than bounded low-polygon display. Primitive proxy assembly is a plausible operating point for this gap, but the current evidence is limited to a seven-class fixed-template OBJ debug prototype, a Python SPPA-DESC/SPPA-UPD v0.2 descriptor/update benchmark, and an optional Unreal descriptor-ingestion path with actor/component replays and a packaged synthetic render benchmark that preserves the asset backend as the default. It is not yet a live, dense UAV/VR runtime benchmark.

The manuscript therefore should not be read as an evaluated UAV/VR system. It defines a runtime contract, descriptor shape, bounded compiler concept, mathematical fitting target, and preregistered evaluation plan. Publication as a full experimental contribution requires the pending implementation, benchmark, fallback, bandwidth, and operator-study artifacts listed above.

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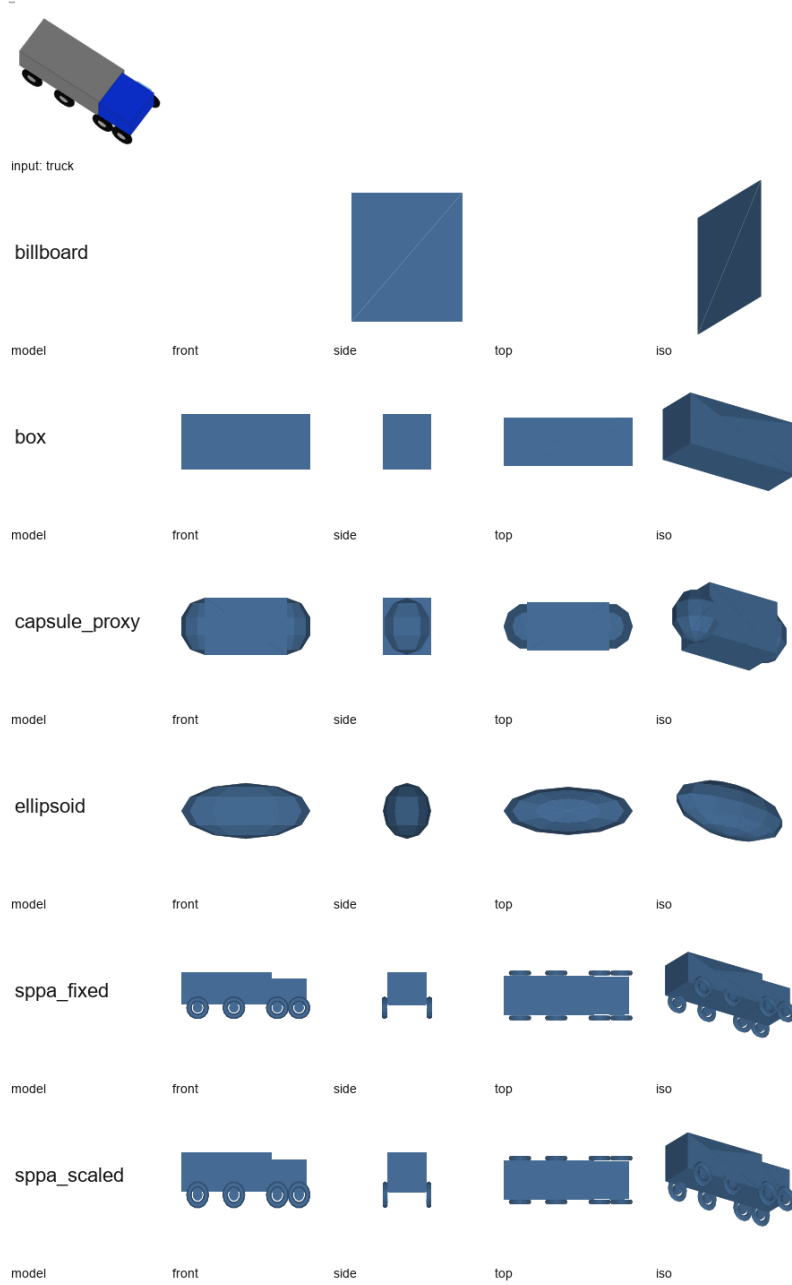


Figure 3: Representative truck views for lightweight baselines. The visual audit shows the trade-off that Table 12 quantifies: boxes and billboards are cheaper, while SPPA preserves more class-specific part structure at higher local construction cost in the Python OBJ debug path.

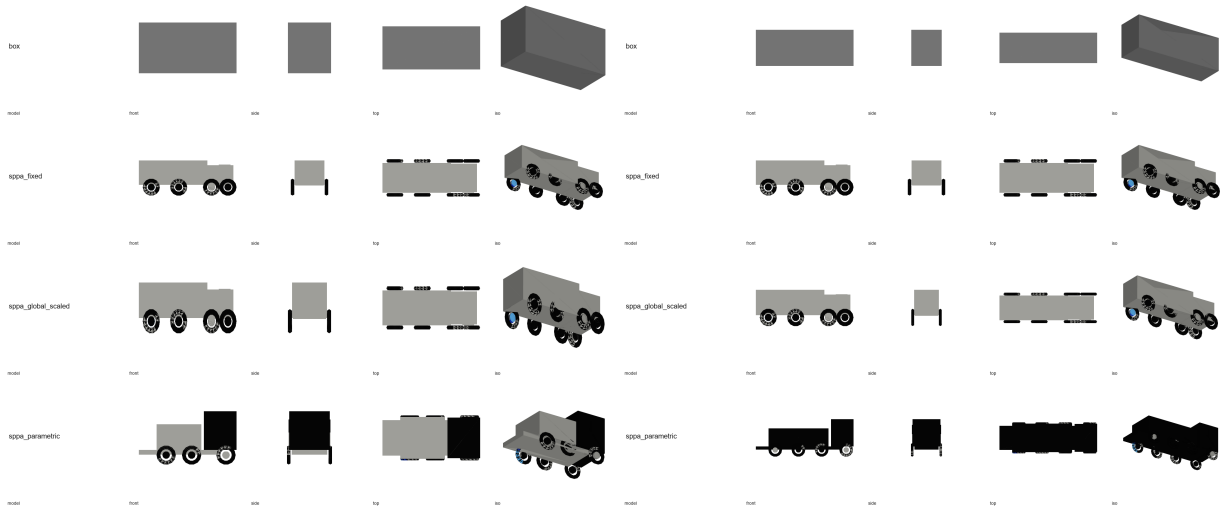


Figure 4: Synthetic short-truck and long-truck scale-variant views. These images document deterministic part-layout adaptation for the vehicle archetype; they are not evidence of real UAV silhouette fitting or human recognition.

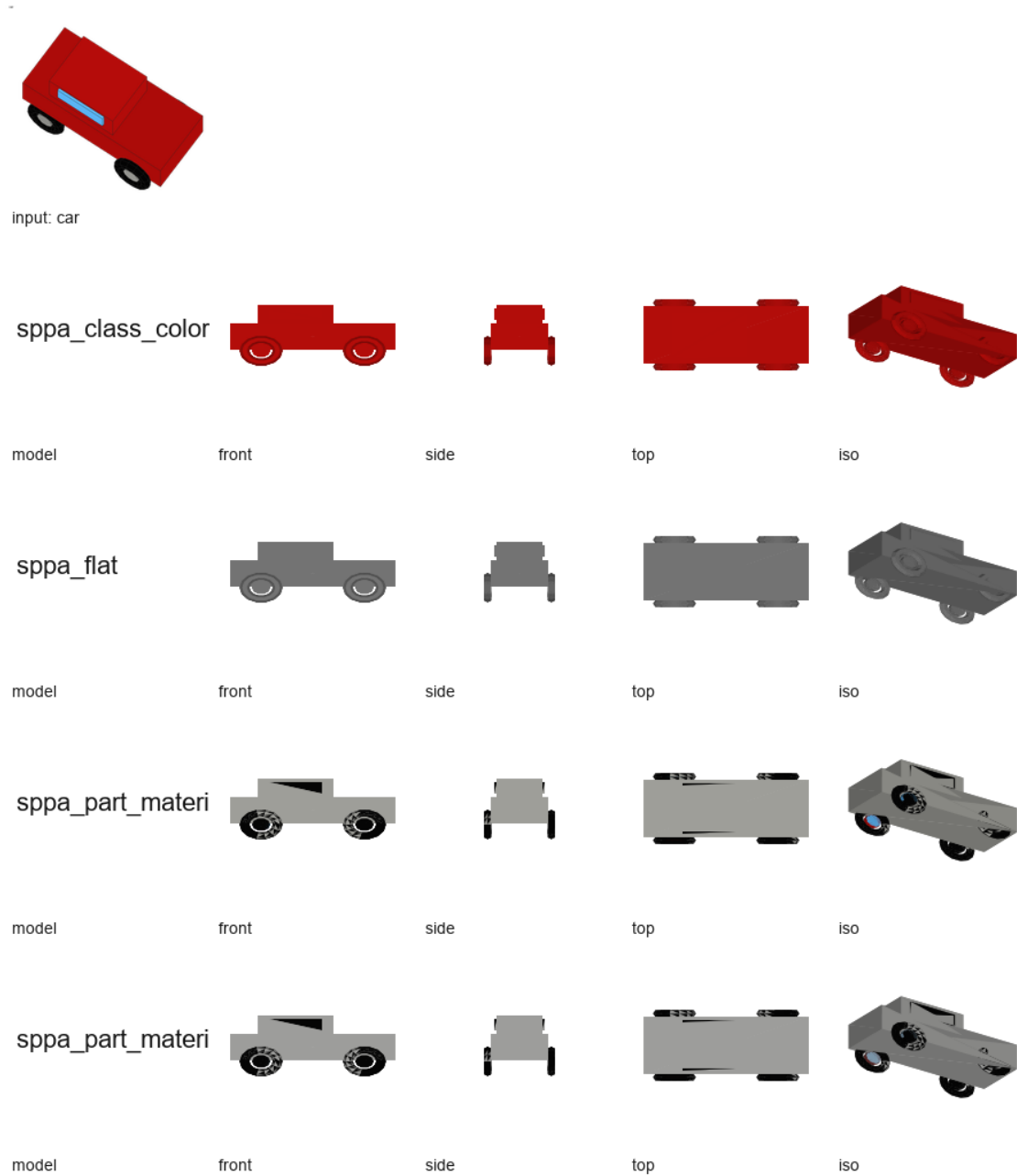


Figure 5: Representative car views for the material ablation. The visual comparison is an audit artifact only: it shows that flat, class-color, and part-material encodings differ, but it does not establish operator recognition or workload benefits.

Table 25: Preregistered experimental matrix for testing SPPA.

Experiment	Baselines	Metrics	Required dataset/artifact	Status
Runtime generation	3D box, capsule/ellipsoid, billboard label, curated low-poly asset load, procedural proxy, SPPA	P50/P95 latency, descriptor bytes, triangles, memory	scripted object-spawn benchmark with cold/warm starts	PENDING-BENCH
Dense VR scene	boxes, capsules, billboards, low-poly assets, instanced primitive proxies, detailed meshes	FPS, CPU/GPU frame time, draw calls at 10/50/100/500 entities	Unreal scene and target head-set/hardware profile	PENDING-BENCH
Proportional adaptation	fixed template, bbox-only scale, curated low-poly asset, SPPA	length/width/height error, BEV IoU, volume over/under-estimation, yaw error	synthetic variants plus real or simulated UAV-view detections	PENDING-EXP
Recognition	boxes, capsule/ellipsoid, billboard label, curated low-poly asset, SPPA	class-family accuracy, response time, confusion matrix	randomized operator recognition task	PENDING-USER
Operational navigation	no rendering, boxes, occupancy volume, SPPA	near misses, clearance, task time, NASA-TLX, SAGAT-style situation-awareness probes	degraded-video VR navigation scenario	PENDING-USER
Fallback and uncertainty	no rendering, generic box, uncertainty shell, SPPA fallback	containment rate, false-confidence events, operator interpretation, unknown-class failure rate	unknown or ambiguous class set with occlusions	PENDING-SAFETY
Ablation	SPPA variants without silhouette, footprint, track smoothing, semantic part graph, or uncertainty display	BEV IoU, yaw error, jitter, recognition accuracy	shared benchmark scenes and tracks	PENDING-EXP
Bandwidth	compressed video, telemetry boxes, SPPA descriptors, full meshes	bytes/s, packet rate, retransmission cost, stale-object rate	network replay or controlled link emulator	PENDING-EXP

Table 26: Missing evidence required before SPPA can be claimed as an evaluated UAV/VR runtime system.

Validation gap	Missing evidence	Required artifact
Prototype is not the full representation layer	No live detections, calibrated georeferencing, real network server, VR headset runtime, or dense rendered descriptor-driven replay from Pipeline B tracks; only an internal synthetic packaged replay is implemented	End-to-end Pipeline B replay that creates SPPA descriptors and Unreal actors from recorded or simulated detections through a packaged Unreal runtime (PENDING-IMPL, PENDING-BENCH)
No packaged broad-baseline comparison	Only no-render and a simple placeholder-asset backend are evaluated in the packaged loop; boxes, capsules, billboards, curated assets, occupancy volumes, and procedural alternatives remain missing from a shared recognition task	Benchmark scripts and tables comparing latency, geometry, frame rate, draw calls, and recognition (PENDING-EXP)
No shape-adaptation evidence	Descriptor-level bbox/dimension scaling is implemented, but real mask/silhouette part fitting and objective geometry error are not measured	Dataset with ground-truth or simulated footprints plus BEV IoU, volume error, yaw error, and mask/silhouette ablations (PENDING-EXP)
No VR runtime evidence	OBJ timing is not headset frame timing	Unreal/VR dense-scene benchmark in a packaged async replay with backend, count, poll rate, action mix, FPS, GameThread, RenderThread, GPU time, draw calls, triangles, memory, hitches, actor count, component count, seed, and build hash (PENDING-BENCH)
No operator evidence	Readability and situation-awareness claims are untested	Controlled user study with recognition, response time, navigation outcome, NASA-TLX, and SAGAT-style probes (PENDING-USER)
No fallback evidence	Conservative display fallback may create false confidence	Unknown-class and ambiguous-detection study with containment, operator interpretation, and failure analysis (PENDING-SAFETY)
No SPPA-specific bandwidth comparison	Descriptor and update-packet bytes are measured only as local JSON artifacts; they are not compared with video, telemetry boxes, or mesh transfer	Network replay/link-emulation report with bytes/s, packet rate, staleness, and failure modes (PENDING-EXP)